

Name: _____



New York State Testing Program

English Language Arts Test Session 1

Grade 6

Spring 2026

RELEASED QUESTIONS

Session 1



TIPS FOR TAKING THE TEST

Here are some ideas to help you do your best:

- Read the whole passage before you answer the questions. Most questions will only make sense after you read the whole passage.
- You might need to read the passage more than once to answer a question.
- Read each question carefully. Take your time.
- A question may include a quote from a passage. You might need to review both the quote and the whole passage to answer the question.

When you write your answers

- make sure to answer the whole question;
- use examples or details from the text;
- write in complete sentences; and
- use correct spelling, grammar, capitalization, and punctuation.

***D*irections**

Read this story. Then answer questions 1 through 7.

In 1906, the narrator attends the rehearsal of a famous opera with her Aunt Sally and her aunt's neighbor, Mr. Steinberg.

Excerpt from *Under the Ashes*

by Cindy Rankin

- 1 Sold Out signs were pasted over Mr. Caruso's profile on all the Carmen posters around the opera house. Two police officers stood off to the side, keeping an eye on things. I asked why, and Mr. Steinberg told me they had to make sure people in our line didn't try to profit by selling their tickets directly to the eager folks in the other line for more than the theater would charge, which I figured was plenty. . . .
- 2 Instead of money, the cashier gave us each a piece of paper he'd stamped with an official-looking seal and told us to join a small group gathered by the big doors. A man in wire-rimmed spectacles poked his head out from behind the middle door. He gestured for us to come inside. We gathered around him in the lobby. . . .
- 3 The man in the gray suit walked to the foot of the widest, fanciest staircase in creation. Polished wood and gold-trimmed molding framed everything around us. He went up the first step, turned, and waved for us to follow. Looking at me, the man said, "Children are not normally allowed." . . .
- 4 As we climbed the magenta-carpeted stairs, Mr. Steinberg leaned near to say, "This is one of the largest, best-appointed opera houses in the entire United States."
- 5 I rubbed the shiny banister. What a fun ride this would be. Mr. Steinberg must have guessed my thought because he winked at me.
- 6 Aunt Sally squeezed close. For an instant I wondered if she too shared the idea of sliding down full-speed.
- 7 "Think of all the elegantly dressed ladies and gentlemen who have stood on these very steps over the years," she said.
- 8 Her imaginings were different from mine. A hint of girlishness flickered across her face. I reckoned she pictured herself wearing a fine evening gown with strings of pearls around her neck and carrying a small fan in her gloved hand. A dashing escort on her arm. A dream she could have lived if she'd only agreed to see the opera tonight with Mr. Steinberg. . . .

GO ON

- 9 “This evening,” the guide said, “our audience, including the city’s elite, will be elbow to elbow for Signore Caruso’s performance as Don Jose, and, of course, Madam Olive Fremstad as Carmen.” He spread his hands wide in front of his chest, continuing, “Every one of the 2,400 seats in the house will be filled.”
- 10 “Golly, that’s more folks than we have in my town!” The words flew from my mouth.
- 11 I stiffened, expecting Aunt Sally to shush or scold me. But the gilded mirror on the wall reflected her turning this way and that, taking in the full splendor of the place. She hadn’t heard me, didn’t even notice people twittering. Her attention rested on the crystal chandelier overhead. Daylight caught its long prisms to cast off colorful patterns against the brocade wallpaper. I realized she was as awed by all this as I’d been when I first experienced the hubbub of the city. . . .
- 12 “Young lady, over four hundred thousand people live in San Francisco,” the guide said. He opened a door and directed us to the balcony, saying, “Our culture rivals the great cities back east.”
- 13 Mr. Steinberg carefully led the way down the steep steps to the front chairs. He and Aunt Sally took a seat on either side of me. I remained on my feet, putting my hands on the railing and leaning over for a bird’s eye view. The rows below us were covered in drop cloths. . . .
- 14 “Ladies and gentlemen.” The man in the gray suit now stood on the main floor in front of the orchestra. He cupped his hands around his mouth to project his voice up to us. “Because the demand to see Signore Caruso is overwhelming,” he said, “the maestro¹ has graciously opened this rehearsal to you. A rare opportunity. Absolute silence is required. No talking or applause. Think of yourselves as flies on the wall, observing, careful not to draw attention, lest you be promptly dispatched.” . . .
- 15 We all inhaled at the same time when Mr. Caruso appeared. He looked just like his picture—a bushy shock of dark hair and portly. But I was shocked to see how short he was. Not nearly as tall as Mr. Steinberg. . . .
- 16 The famous Caruso strode to center stage then let out the fullest, most peculiar, yet perfect sound I’d ever heard. Music from the pit filtered in beneath his tones. . . .
- 17 Then the tenor’s voice captured me. It unfurled like a bolt of rich silk floating over the stage—higher and higher it went, until it dipped thrillingly low, then rose again. It filled all the space inside this grand theater. His voice was gigantic, even if he was not.
- 18 Hairs on my neck and arms tingled and stood straight up. My heart raced to hold the notes, to ride the current of the melody. Closed my eyes, stretched my ears wide, and listened with my whole body. When he finished, I had to suck air into my lungs. Nothing had ever taken my breath away like the magical sound of Mr. Caruso’s voice.

¹**maestro:** person who writes and conducts music

1 In paragraphs 3 through 5, how does the narrator’s opinion affect the description of the theater?

- A** The narrator believes the theater is confusing and is glad to have a guided tour.
- B** The narrator believes the theater is boring, so she considers sliding down the banister.
- C** The narrator believes the theater is unwelcoming because children are forbidden.
- D** The narrator believes the theater is grand, so she describes its structures and elegance.

2 As used in paragraph 11, what does the word “awed” suggest about Aunt Sally?

- A** She is distracted by the activity in the theater.
- B** She is amazed by the magnificence of the place.
- C** She is bothered by the patterns on the wallpaper.
- D** She is embarrassed by the comments of the narrator.

3 What do the details in paragraphs 10 through 12 reveal about the narrator?

- A** She is from a small town that is less busy than San Francisco.
- B** She wishes she had dressed more nicely for the theater.
- C** She often visits the city of San Francisco.
- D** She admires all the objects in the theater.

GO ON

4

What is the meaning of the word “dispatched” as it is used in paragraph 14?

- A** made to leave the theater
- B** ordered to speak quietly
- C** asked to join the performance
- D** told to listen carefully

5

Music can be a powerful force for some people. How do the details in paragraphs 15 through 18 support this idea in the story?

- A** by showing the audience’s reaction to Caruso’s appearance
- B** by telling where Caruso stands during the performance
- C** by describing the narrator’s reaction to Caruso’s singing
- D** by highlighting how Caruso walks to the center of the stage

6

Which detail represents a turning point in the direction of the story?

- A** The cashier gives pieces of paper to the narrator, Aunt Sally, and Mr. Steinberg.
- B** The theater guide leads the guests to the foot of a wide, fancy staircase.
- C** Mr. Caruso walks onto the stage and begins to sing.
- D** Mr. Steinberg leads the narrator and Aunt Sally to their seats.

7

Which detail would be **most** important to include in a summary of the story?

- A** The narrator and Aunt Sally attend an opera rehearsal with Mr. Steinberg.
- B** The narrator wonders if Aunt Sally also wants to slide down the banister.
- C** Aunt Sally tells the narrator to think about past guests of the opera house.
- D** Aunt Sally and Mr. Steinberg sit on either side of the narrator in the balcony.

GO ON

Directions Read this article. Then answer questions 15 through 21.

Rescuing Orphan Elephants

by Amy Tao

1 What would you do if you found a stray kitten? Give it a saucer of milk, cuddle it and keep it warm, try to convince Mom you need a new pet? Sounds good. But what if you found a baby elephant?

2 Little lost elephants may not be common in your neighborhood, but they are in Kenya in East Africa. And the best thing to do there is call the David Sheldrick Wildlife Trust. They've been rescuing orphan elephants and successfully reintroducing them to the wild for more than 25 years.

3 Raising a baby elephant is a big responsibility. Like people, healthy elephants can live 70 years or longer, and their development is remarkably similar to ours. Babies two years and younger need almost constant attention. Children begin doing some things on their own but still need to be with their families. Teenagers are more independent, but elephants aren't considered fully adult until they're in their thirties. So taking in a stray elephant requires a long-term commitment.

4 It's hard work, too. A baby elephant can usually stand and walk soon after it's born, but for almost everything else during the next several years it depends on its mother. It drinks about five gallons of milk a day and must be fed every two hours. It needs to be kept warm but can't stay in the sun too long or its tender baby skin might get sunburned. It has to be taught how to behave and communicate—even how to use its trunk, which babies sometimes trip over while walking. And it needs to feel safe and loved.

In the Nursery

5 When a baby elephant first arrives at the orphanage nursery, one of the biggest problems it faces is grief. Elephants are highly intelligent, loving family members. In the wild, a female elephant usually stays with her family her whole life. Males don't leave until they're in their teens and then frequently return to visit. A baby separated from its family may feel so sad that it becomes ill and dies. The keepers at the Sheldrick Trust, therefore, must become the baby's substitute family. They spend every hour—waking and sleeping—with the little orphans, forming a lifelong friendship. They've learned, however, that each baby should have several human family members. If a baby bonds with only one person, it may become depressed when that person leaves, even to go home for a night.

GO ON

6 The keepers spend a lot of their time just feeding the babies. Sometimes they have to teach a baby how to drink from a bottle. In the wild, a baby elephant will stand under its mother and rest its trunk on her body as it nurses with its mouth. To make bottle-feeding feel less strange, the keepers often hang big blankets for the orphans to cuddle up against while they drink. As they get more comfortable, the babies begin to wind their trunks around the keepers instead.

7 Those blankets have another useful purpose. They keep the orphans warm on cool mornings and evenings. A baby's elephant family would normally protect it from cold or bad weather by surrounding it and sheltering it from wind or rain. Standing under mom or in her giant shadow protects the baby from sunburn, too. The keepers aren't big enough to offer much weather protection all by themselves so they rely on blankets and parasols¹ and mud.

8 Yes, mud. Every day the orphans and their keepers go for a mud bath. Not only is the mud fun to play in, but the babies learn that a nice coating of gooey mud can cool them off on a hot day. As the mud dries, it continues to protect them from the sun and prevents ticks and other insects from biting them. Most of the babies love the mud, but if one's a little shy, the keepers gently coax it into a shallow puddle and scoop mud on it, just like a mom would, only with a shovel in place of a trunk.

At Tsavo National Park

9 When an orphan has its first birthday, it's ready to move from the nursery to Tsavo National Park, where it will eventually be released into the wild elephant community. The orphans always go to Tsavo in a group. Being very social animals, they feel more at home when they're part of a herd. And they are always accompanied by their keepers.

10 They're not ready to roam free yet, though. They still need to be bottle-fed for at least one more year, and they're still too little to be safe from lions and other predators in the park, so they live in a stockade² with their keepers. But the keepers take them into the wild every day and show them which grasses and leaves are good to eat. Older, previously released orphans welcome and befriend the newcomers and help teach them proper elephant behavior. They introduce the orphans to the wild herds, and gradually the orphans begin to spend more time with other elephants than with their human keepers.

11 There's no special age for releasing an orphan. Whenever it's ready—and every elephant is different—it just stops returning to the stockade at night and joins an elephant family. It never forgets its human family, though, and will often visit, helping to welcome the newest orphans.

¹**parasols:** umbrellas

²**stockade:** enclosed area

15

Read this sentence from paragraph 5.

When a baby elephant first arrives at the orphanage nursery, one of the biggest problems it faces is grief.

What does the use of the word “grief” in the article show about baby elephants?

- A They have strong emotions.
- B They are unable to be cared for by humans.
- C They have difficulty bonding with caretakers.
- D They must learn to drink from a bottle.

16

Which sentence **best** supports the author’s indication that raising baby elephants is a great responsibility?

- A “They’ve been rescuing orphan elephants and successfully reintroducing them to the wild for more than 25 years.” (paragraph 2)
- B “When a baby elephant first arrives at the orphanage nursery, one of the biggest problems it faces is grief.” (paragraph 5)
- C “They spend every hour—waking and sleeping—with the little orphans, forming a lifelong friendship.” (paragraph 5)
- D “Sometimes they have to teach a baby how to drink from a bottle.” (paragraph 6)

GO ON

Read this sentence from paragraph 5.

Elephants are highly intelligent, loving family members.

Which detail from the article **best** supports this claim?

- A "... healthy elephants can live 70 years or longer, and their development is remarkably similar to ours." (paragraph 3)
- B "... a baby elephant will stand under its mother and rest its trunk on her body as it nurses with its mouth." (paragraph 6)
- C "... it's ready to move from the nursery to Tsavo National Park, where it will eventually be released into the wild elephant community." (paragraph 9)
- D "... previously released orphans welcome and befriend the newcomers and help teach them proper elephant behavior." (paragraph 10)

Which sentence from the article **best** shows that orphaned elephants often form long-term relationships with human keepers?

- A "It has to be taught how to behave and communicate—even how to use its trunk, which babies sometimes trip over while walking." (paragraph 4)
- B "As they get more comfortable, the babies begin to wind their trunks around the keepers instead." (paragraph 6)
- C "Not only is the mud fun to play in, but the babies learn that a nice coating of gooey mud can cool them off on a hot day." (paragraph 8)
- D "It never forgets its human family, though, and will often visit, helping to welcome the newest orphans." (paragraph 11)

19

How does paragraph 11 provide support for a central idea of the article?

- A by identifying the age that is appropriate for orphan elephants to be released
- B by describing the way older elephants will welcome new orphans into a herd
- C by explaining why elephants are returned to the same stockade each night
- D by showing that baby elephants make strong connections when cared for

20

In the article, what is the **main** way the author develops the role of the caretakers?

- A by comparing the way elephants are treated in different parts of the world to the way they are treated in Kenya
- B by providing examples of the activities that orphaned elephants experience while living at the Wildlife Trust
- C by describing how orphan elephants are moved from the Wildlife Trust to Tsavo National Park when they are a year old
- D by explaining how the Wildlife Trust started its mission of saving orphaned elephants several years before

21

According to a well-known science professor, “Empathy is the ability to share and understand the feelings of another.” How does the author develop this idea in the article?

- A by describing the process that orphaned elephants must go through to find a new herd
- B by including detailed descriptions of the activities of baby elephants at a national park
- C by describing how caretakers imitate elephant behaviors to help baby elephants experience love
- D by including information about the daily physical needs of rescued orphaned elephants

GO ON

Directions

Read this article. Then answer questions 22 through 28.

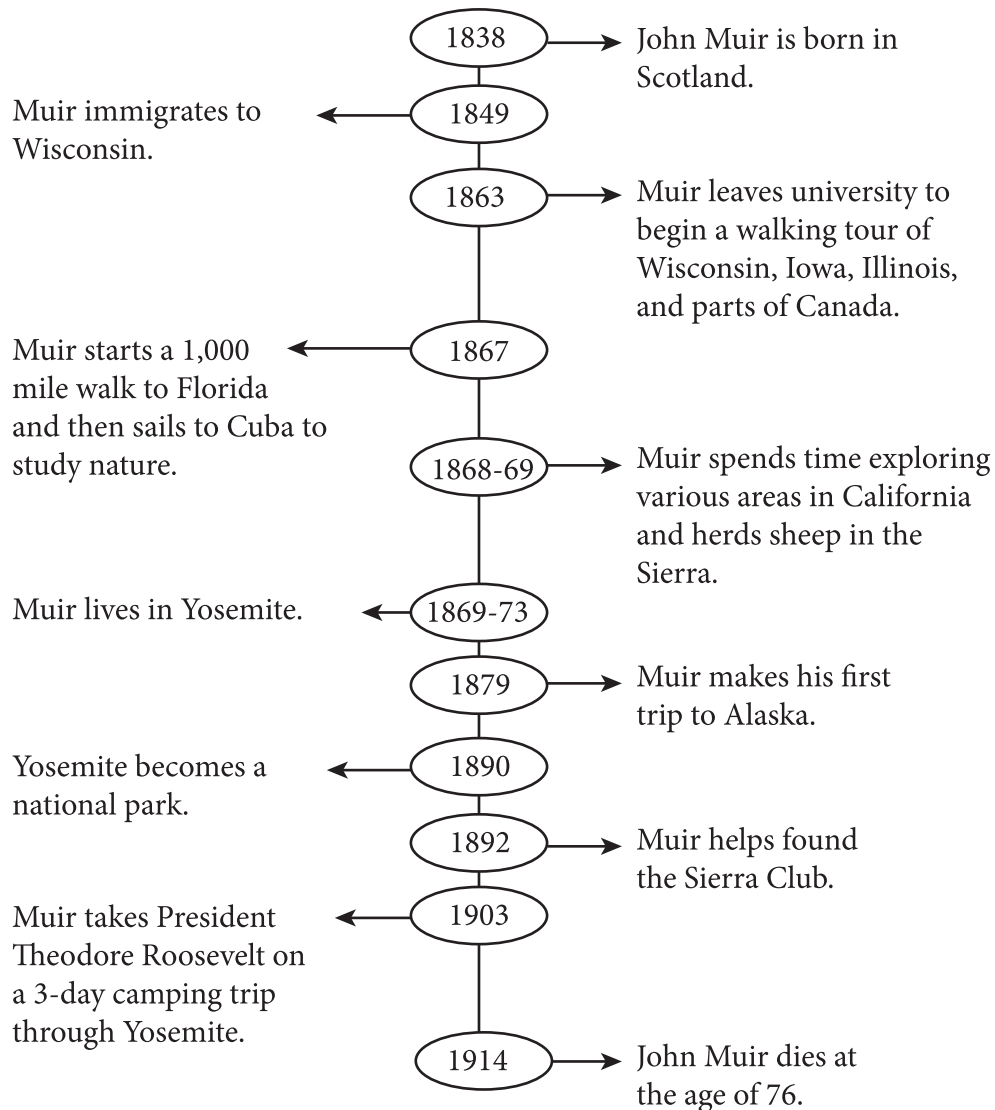
Excerpt from “Man on a Mission”

by Carollyne Hutter

- 1 Every year, about 4 million people from around the world travel to California to see the stunning beauty of Yosemite National Park. The park exists thanks to the efforts of a single man who spent decades fighting to preserve wilderness areas: John Muir. Today, Muir is referred to as “Father of Our National Parks” and is famous as one of America’s first environmentalists. His love of nature and his writings inspired others to take action and protect our nation’s natural places.
- 2 Muir was born on April 21, 1838, in Dunbar, Scotland. When he was 11, his family moved to a small farm in Wisconsin. He worked 16 hours a day on the farm, but he had a tremendous hunger for knowledge. “I loved to read, and I wanted to learn about everything,” he explained. He often read books before he began his chores.
- 3 Although Muir’s formal education ended with his family’s move to Wisconsin, he enrolled in classes at the University of Wisconsin when he was 23 years old. After 2½ years, he became restless and decided to explore the world and study nature instead of staying to graduate. In 1864, he went to Canada for a couple of years and then to Indianapolis, Indiana. While he was working at a carriage factory there in 1867, an accident injured his right eye. He was blind and in pain for weeks. He feared that he would never again see the natural world that he loved.
- 4 In time, Muir’s sight came back. When it did, he decided to devote himself to the study of nature. He left the factory and set off on a 1,000 mile walk to Florida to study plants. The next year, Muir sailed to Cuba and then to San Francisco. From there, he headed eastward to see the wilderness of the Sierra Nevada. He explored Yosemite Valley, located within that mountain range. It was a place that few people visited in those days, and Muir fell in love with its beauty.
- 5 For the rest of his life, Muir was happiest when he was hiking and camping in the mountains. Often, he carried “only a tin cup, a handful of tea, a loaf of bread,” and a journal. He began to offer guided tours in Yosemite in 1870, and in 1871, the *New York Tribune* published his first article about the site’s glaciers.

- 6 Muir spent years studying the area's plants and glaciers. He marveled at Yosemite's majestic waterfalls, massive granite cliffs, and giant sequoia trees. He continued writing about what he saw and learned, and he also gave lectures. His newspaper articles gave him a large audience interested in learning about his experiences.
- 7 In the mid-1800s, railroad, lumber, and mining companies wanted to own or develop any land in the West that might offer a profit. Muir was determined to protect the wilderness he loved from being permanently destroyed by those large industries. . . .
- 8 Muir worked with politicians to make Yosemite and other places be protected by the federal government rather than a state government. On October 1, 1890, Muir and his supporters won a big battle. The US Congress established Yosemite National Park. It was the second national park in the United States—Yellowstone had been carved out of the Wyoming Territory in 1872. Then, in May 1892, Muir and others set up the Sierra Club, an organization of citizens who wanted to protect the entire Sierra Nevada region. Muir was its first president. . . .
- 9 Muir spent the rest of his life exploring nature, writing about it, and fighting to save wilderness areas. His knowledge and his passion about nature made him an influential voice. He did not win every battle, however. He fought for 12 years to save Hetch Hetchy Valley in Yosemite, but in 1913 Congress allowed the site to be dammed to create a reservoir. As one historian later put it, the destruction of that beautiful valley went down in history as “the worst disaster ever to come to any national park.” Yet it is often held up as an example of the importance of preserving natural areas. Today, John Muir's spirit lives on through his writings, the work of the Sierra Club, and the various natural sites that are named for him.

TIMELINE OF JOHN MUIR'S LIFE



22

How is John Muir first introduced in paragraph 1 of the article?

- A with a story about his life
- B with a listing of his accomplishments
- C with an example that shows the impact of his work
- D with a comparison between him and other conservationists

23

What is the **main** way paragraphs 2 and 3 contribute to the organization of the article?

- A by providing biographical information about Muir
- B by giving examples of what inspired Muir to study nature
- C by sharing stories that come from Muir's writings
- D by highlighting Muir's opinions about the importance of nature

24

Read this sentence from paragraph 5.

Often, he carried “only a tin cup, a handful of tea, a loaf of bread,” and a journal.

What can the reader conclude about Muir from this sentence?

- A He was often poorly prepared for his trips.
- B He usually preferred to be by himself.
- C He chose to live as simply as possible.
- D He made sacrifices to study nature.

GO ON

25

In paragraph 6, what is the **main** effect of the author's word choice?

- A to emphasize the number of glaciers found in Yosemite
- B to indicate the importance of the lectures Muir gave about Yosemite
- C to highlight the great size of some natural features in Yosemite
- D to illustrate the popularity of the articles Muir wrote about Yosemite

26

Which detail **best** expresses a central idea of the article?

- A "His love of nature and his writings inspired others to take action . . ." (paragraph 1)
- B "... he became restless and decided to explore the world and study nature . . ." (paragraph 3)
- C "From there, he headed eastward to see the wilderness . . ." (paragraph 4)
- D "... newspaper articles gave him a large audience interested in learning . . ." (paragraph 6)

27

How did Muir's experience at a carriage factory **most** affect his life?

- A It gave him a reason to leave college and explore the world.
- B It taught him about the hardships associated with certain jobs.
- C It showed him the importance of choosing to live in different places.
- D It made him think carefully about how he wanted to spend his time.

28

This question is worth 2 credits.

How does the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” help develop a central idea of the article? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

STOP

Session 2



TIPS FOR TAKING THE TEST

Here are some ideas to help you do your best:

- Read the whole passage before you answer the questions. Most questions will only make sense after you read the whole passage.
- You might need to read the passage more than once to answer a question.
- Read each question carefully. Take your time.
- A question may include a quote from a passage. You might need to review both the quote and the whole passage to answer the question.

When you write your answers

- make sure to answer the whole question;
- use examples or details from the text;
- write in complete sentences; and
- use correct spelling, grammar, capitalization, and punctuation.

For the last question in this test book, you may plan your writing on the Planning Page provided. However, do NOT write your final answer on the Planning Page. Write your final answer on the lined pages.

***D*irections**

Read this story. Then answer questions 29 through 35.

A young man goes into a swamp hoping to take a photo of a rare woodpecker. He stores his photos and other things in an airtight ammo can.

Excerpt from *The True Blue Scouts of Sugar Man Swamp*

by Kathi Appelt

- 1 Back in 1949, there were no feral¹ hogs in the Sugar Man Swamp. Not one. But Audie Brayburn hadn't gone to the swamp to look for hogs.
- 2 From the time he was fifteen until he turned twenty, he worked for a bakery in southeast Houston. For those five years he worked as many hours as he could, until by 1949 he saved enough money to buy a brand-new DeSoto Sportsman.²
- 3 It had always been his dream to find the ivory-billed woodpecker, ever since he was a small boy and his father gave him his first birder's journal. In fact, his nickname was Audubon, for the famous avian artist, John James Audubon. It was quickly shortened to Audie. So, once he had that DeSoto, and a little pocket change left over, he headed east, to the first place he thought he might find the elusive woodpecker—the Sugar Man Swamp.
- 4 All he took with him were his old binoculars, his sketchbook, a Hohner Marine Band harmonica, and his Polaroid Land Camera, given to him by his parents as a parting gift. He also took a .30-caliber steel ammo can, which he bought at the Army/Navy Surplus. It was airtight and watertight, perfect for keeping his matches dry, and also for storing any photos that he took on his camera. One-of-a-kind photos.
- 5 After hours of driving, he finally found his way to the Sugar Man Swamp. He had never seen so many old trees, including dead trees that were still standing, perfect trees for woodpecker nests. He parked the DeSoto, set up his camp, and settled in.
- 6 At first, the critters of the forest dodged out of his way and stayed hidden from his sight. After all, most of the humans who entered their domain brought arrows and guns and traps with them. But as the days passed, the animals began to notice that Audie wasn't toting anything except for a pair of binoculars, a camera, an ammo can, and a book that he was always scratching in. And they loved the tunes he played on his harmonica. Just loved them.
- 7 Pretty soon Audie Brayburn was considered an Honorary Swamp Critter.

GO ON

- 8 One day he got out his Polaroid Land Camera, pointed it toward an armadillo, and took his shot. As soon as he pulled the back of the film from the photo, he smiled. There, printed on the slick paper, was a perfect, instant picture of a nine-banded armadillo, a surprised-looking armadillo, at that. Audie rolled a tube of gooey “coater” over the photo and waved it in the air until it was dry.
- 9 Just as he tucked the photo of the armadillo into his ammo can, he heard the unmistakable sound he had been waiting for. A sharp *kint kint* followed by *kaPOW kaPOW*.
- 10 Only one creature on the entire planet made that sound, only one. He grabbed his binoculars and his camera and followed it. His heart raced in the same rhythm—*kaPOW kaPOW kaPOW*. He hurried, stepping as lightly as he could. He paused here and there to cock his ears. Hours passed, and the sound pulled him deeper and deeper into the woods.
- 11 As he walked, he was so intent upon keeping the beautiful bird within earshot that he failed to notice that the air had grown increasingly still. Not a single leaf fluttered. Not a single animal stirred. . . .
- 12 Audie Brayburn should have paid attention to all that quiet, all that stillness. If he had, he would have realized that the only time the forest became that still was right before a major storm.
- 13 Instead, he kept following the certain sound of the ivory-billed woodpecker. The air was unbearably hot, sweat soaked his clothes, the water from the swampy floor oozed into his boots, making them feel like lead weights on his feet. He was hungry and thirsty, but more than that, he was determined.
- 14 And then, just before the sun gave up for the day, Audie felt a whoosh of powerful wings fly just over his head, and he knew, he knew what it was, and with utter joy he spoke the words he’d been longing to say his whole life long. “Lord God, what a bird!”
- 15 The beautiful black wings with their trailing white feathers and the large red crest on the bird’s head left no doubt. Everything about the bird said *ivory-bill*.
- 16 Audie raised his Polaroid Land Camera and snapped his shot. When he pulled the strip of film out and peeled the back off, there it was, in black and white: the broad black wings with their trailing feathers, the stripes on the sides of its neck, and the tall crest on its head. Audie opened the tube of coater and covered the surface of the shot, making sure there weren’t any streaks. Then he waved the photo in the air until it dried, and slipped it into the ammo can. All just in time, because in the very next instant the rain began to fall, and there he was, deep, deep in the heart of the Sugar Man Swamp, without any idea where he was or where he had left his DeSoto Sportsman.

¹**feral:** wild

²**DeSoto Sportsman:** a type of car

29

Read this sentence from paragraph 7.

Pretty soon Audie Brayburn was considered an Honorary Swamp Critter.

Which important idea does the author develop in this sentence?

- A** Audie has not told many people that he went to the swamp.
- B** Audie seems to belong in his surroundings in the swamp.
- C** Audie becomes interested in other animals in the swamp.
- D** Audie does not remember how to get out of the swamp.

30

The author's word choice in paragraph 9 affects the story by

- A** introducing an anxious tone
- B** introducing an excited tone
- C** creating a playful tone
- D** creating an impatient tone

31

In paragraph 11, the phrase "keeping the beautiful bird within earshot" suggests that

- A** Audie needs to hear the woodpecker to locate it
- B** Audie hopes that hunters will leave the woodpecker alone
- C** Audie wants to avoid frightening the woodpecker
- D** Audie thinks that the song of the woodpecker is pleasant

GO ON

32

How does paragraph 12 relate to paragraph 16?

- A Paragraph 12 introduces a new setting that is further described in paragraph 16.
- B Paragraph 12 describes a decision that the main character regrets in paragraph 16.
- C Paragraph 12 mentions an event that is described in a flashback in paragraph 16.
- D Paragraph 12 foreshadows an event that begins to occur in paragraph 16.

33

Which sentence **best** shows the rising action in the story?

- A “From the time he was fifteen until he turned twenty, he worked for a bakery in southeast Houston.” (paragraph 2)
- B “He had never seen so many old trees, including dead trees that were still standing, perfect trees for woodpecker nests.” (paragraph 5)
- C “Only one creature on the entire planet made that sound, only one.” (paragraph 10)
- D “Then he waved the photo in the air until it dried, and slipped it into the ammo can.” (paragraph 16)

34

Which statement **best** expresses a theme of the story?

- A Being alone in nature can relieve stress.
- B Trying a new activity is often rewarding.
- C Certain locations are potentially dangerous.
- D Some people are driven by their interests.

GO ON

35

How does the author **mainly** convey Audie's character in the story?

- A by allowing the reader to understand the reasons for his tools
- B by describing his choices and actions to the reader
- C by helping the reader understand some of his childhood interests
- D by sharing his thoughts and concerns with the reader

GO ON

Directions
Read this story. Then answer questions 36 and 37.

Excerpt from *Pig Tales*

by Kate Tym

- 1 Sharon Black had never considered herself an impulsive¹ person until the day she fell in love with a pot-bellied pig! It was 1996 and she'd been doing some reading around the subject of being a pot-bellied pig owner and had very much taken to the idea. She persuaded her somewhat skeptical² husband to drive her over to Oklahoma City and a date with fate was set.
- 2 When she arrived at the house that had three pigs for sale, Sharon knew she wasn't going to leave without one . . . they were all so cute. And when she looked at Peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one.
- 3 Peaches was amazing; she picked up on things so quickly. She was completely house-trained within a few days and soon figured out that the fridge door was the best one to learn how to open! She could get at it with her snout and it soon became clear that anything openable was going to have to be fitted with child-proof locks for as long as Peaches was around!
- 4 Peaches and Sharon have a wonderful time together. As long as Peaches is rested and well fed she's as happy as anything. She loves the pillows on Sharon's couch and if one of them happens to be on the floor she runs up and grabs it with her snout and tosses it up in the air. Then, when it lands on the floor she falls over on it and plays dead; she rolls her eyes up in her head and becomes totally still . . . until someone laughs, then she jumps straight back up and starts the whole routine all over again. She'll keep doing it for ages and ages and then, as soon as she's had enough, she lies down and has a nap.
- 5 Sharon says Peaches is very much like a child and she even hires babysitters for her as there's just too much mischief she could get up to while Sharon's out. She follows Sharon from room to room, curls up to watch TV with her and even sleeps in Sharon's bed!
- 6 One day when Sharon had to leave the house in an emergency, she put Peaches to bed and drew the blinds hoping she would think it was night time and take a quick nap but when Sharon returned home she found Peaches, in the middle of the floor . . . "sobbing!" Peaches was so glad to see Sharon back that she jumped up and smothered her in piggy-love!
- 7 Peaches loves her weekly bath and her favorite snacks for special times are white seedless grapes and apple juice and . . . Pepsi—but only if she manages to get her snout on someone's open can and slurp it down really fast before she gets caught!

GO ON

- 8 Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words. There is never a dull moment with Peaches around and their relationship is a perfect partnership as Peaches only gives back the love she gets given by having a very special place in a very special household.

¹**impulsive:** acting without thinking

²**skeptical:** unwilling to go along with an idea or action because of worries or doubts

GO ON

36

This question is worth 2 credits.

In *Pig Tales*, how does the information in paragraph 2 connect with the information in paragraph 8? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

GO ON

37

This question is worth 2 credits.

Some people think that pigs make great pets. How does the author develop this idea in *Pig Tales*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

GO ON

Directions Read this poem. Then answer questions 38 and 39.

We Keep a Pig in the Parlor

by Suzanne Bloom

Some people keep pigs in a pigpen,
Or out in a field roaming free.
We keep a pig in the parlor.
He sleeps on the settee.¹

5 He used to live in the pig barn,
And sit looking out at the field,
 Till a plan took shape
 For a great escape,
 “I want to be free,” he squealed.

10 He fairly flew out of the window,
With a run and a jump and a grunt.
 He came down in the mud
 With a squishy, soft thud,
It was quite an incredible stunt.

15 He wandered way out to the pasture
In search of some company.
 “I just want a friend to spend time with,”
He said, grinning sheepishly.²

GO ON

We pitched him back in the pig barn,
20 Tail over snout over heels.
 A pen made of pine
 Is just fine for a swine,
No matter how loudly he squeals.

Outside he heard quizzical quacking
25 And finding a large enough crack
 Between two loose boards
 That rattled like gourds,³
He squeezed himself out of that shack.

The zucchini and peas looked so tempting
30 And the broccoli grew in great clumps.
His tummy felt ever so empty.
He ate everything but the stumps.

You know, pig, you're driving me crazy.
Why are you doing this stuff?
35 The garden and barn are a terrible mess.
Enough is enough is enough!

He looked at me sadly and mumbled,
"I'm sorry I've been such a pest."

GO ON

Then he snorted and said,
40 “I detest a straw bed,
Corn that’s unpopped
Supper called slop.
Mud on my face,
that ramshackle⁴ place.
45 It makes me disgruntled,⁵ at best.

Besides,” he said, “I’m so lonesome,”
And he rested his head on my knee.
As I hugged him I had an idea.
“Piggy, cheer up. Follow me.”

50 So, we keep our pig in the parlor;
He sleeps on the settee.
We watch TV,
Have popcorn and tea
As cozy as we can be.

¹**settee:** sofa

²**sheepishly:** in an embarrassed way

³**gourds:** the shells of dried fruit with seeds inside

⁴**ramshackle:** broken down

⁵**disgruntled:** unhappy, upset

38

This question is worth 2 credits.

What does the phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* suggest about the pig? Include your claim and use **two** details from the poem to support your response.

GO ON

Planning Page

You may PLAN your writing for question 39 here if you wish, but do NOT write your final answer on this page. Writing on this Planning Page will NOT count toward your final score. Write your final answer on Pages 17 and 18.



GO ON

39

This question is worth 4 credits.

The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

[illegible]

THE STATE EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
THE UNIVERSITY OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK / ALBANY, NY 12234
2026 English Language Arts Tests Map to the Standards
Grade 6

Question	Type	Key	Points	Standard	Strand	Subscore	Secondary Standard(s)
Session 1							
1	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R6	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
2	Multiple Choice	B	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R4	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
3	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R3	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
4	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6L4	Language Standards	Reading	
5	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R9	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
6	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R3	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
7	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R2	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
15	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R4	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
16	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R2	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
17	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R8	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
18	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R6	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
19	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R5	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
20	Multiple Choice	B	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R3	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
21	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R9	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
22	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R3	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
23	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R5	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
24	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R4	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
25	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R4	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
26	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R2	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
27	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R3	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Reading	
28	Constructed Response		2	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R7	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Writing to Sources	
Session 2							
29	Multiple Choice	B	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R2	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
30	Multiple Choice	B	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R4	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
31	Multiple Choice	A	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6L4	Language Standards	Reading	
32	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R5	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
33	Multiple Choice	C	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R3	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
34	Multiple Choice	D	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R2	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
35	Multiple Choice	B	1	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R6	Reading Standards for Literature	Reading	
36	Constructed Response		2	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R5	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Writing to Sources	
37	Constructed Response		2	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R9	Reading Standards for Informational Text	Writing to Sources	
38	Constructed Response		2	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R4	Reading Standards for Literature	Writing to Sources	
39	Constructed Response		4	NGLS.ELA.Content.NY-6R3	Reading Standards for Literature	Writing to Sources	

*This item map is intended to identify the primary analytic skills necessary to successfully answer each question on the 2026 operational ELA test. However, each constructed-response question measures proficiencies described in multiple standards, including writing and additional reading and language standards. For example, two-point and four-point constructed-response questions require students to first conduct the analyses described in the mapped standard and then produce written responses that are rated based on writing standards. To gain greater insight into the measurement focus for constructed-response questions, please refer to the rubrics shown in the Educator Guides.

2-Credit Constructed-Response Rubric

Score	Response Features
2 Credits	The features of a 2-credit response are • Valid inferences and/or claims from the text where required by the prompt • Evidence of analysis of the text where required by the prompt • Relevant facts, definitions, concrete details, and/or other information from the text to develop response according to the requirements of the prompt • Sufficient number of facts, definitions, concrete details, and/or other information from the text as required by the prompt • Complete sentences where errors do not impact readability
1 Credit	The features of a 1-credit response are • A mostly literal recounting of events or details from the text as required by the prompt • Some relevant facts, definitions, concrete details, and/or other information from the text to develop response according to the requirements of the prompt • Incomplete sentences or bullets
0 Credits*	The features of a 0-credit response are • A response that does not address any of the requirements of the prompt or is totally inaccurate • A response that is not written in English • A response that is unintelligible or indecipherable

- If the prompt requires two texts and the student only references one text, the response can be scored no higher than a 1.

* Condition Code A is applied whenever a student who is present for a test session leaves an entire constructed-response question in that session completely blank (no response attempted).

New York State Grades 6–8 Writing Evaluation Rubric

CRITERIA	NGLS	SCORE				
		4 Essays at this level:	3 Essays at this level:	2 Essays at this level:	1 Essays at this level:	0* Essays at this level:
CONTENT AND ANALYSIS: the extent to which the essay conveys ideas and information clearly and accurately in order to support analysis of topics or text(s)	W.2 R.1–9	—clearly introduce a topic in a manner that is compelling and follows logically from the task and purpose —demonstrate insightful analysis of the text(s)	—clearly introduce a topic in a manner that follows from the task and purpose —demonstrate grade-appropriate analysis of the text(s)	—introduce a topic in a manner that follows generally from the task and purpose —demonstrate a literal comprehension of the text(s)	—introduce a topic in a manner that does not logically follow from the task and purpose —demonstrate little understanding of the text(s)	—demonstrate a lack of comprehension of the text(s) or task
COMMAND OF EVIDENCE: the extent to which the essay presents evidence from the provided text(s) to support analysis and reflection	W.2 R.1–8	—develop the topic with relevant, well-chosen facts, definitions, concrete details, quotations, or other information and examples from the text(s) —sustain the use of varied, relevant evidence	—develop the topic with relevant facts, definitions, details, quotations, or other information and examples from the text(s) —sustain the use of relevant evidence, with some lack of variety	—partially develop the topic of the essay with the use of some textual evidence, some of which may be irrelevant —use relevant evidence with inconsistency	—demonstrate an attempt to use evidence, but only develop ideas with minimal, occasional evidence which is generally invalid or irrelevant	—provide no evidence or provide evidence that is completely irrelevant
COHERENCE, ORGANIZATION, AND STYLE: the extent to which the essay logically organizes complex ideas, concepts, and information using formal style and precise language	W.2 L.3 L.6	—exhibit clear organization, with the skillful use of appropriate and varied transitions to create a unified whole and enhance meaning —establish and maintain a formal style, using grade-appropriate, stylistically sophisticated language and domain-specific vocabulary with a notable sense of voice —provide a concluding statement or section that is compelling and follows clearly from the topic and information presented	—exhibit clear organization, with the use of appropriate transitions to create a unified whole —establish and maintain a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary —provide a concluding statement or section that follows from the topic and information presented	—exhibit some attempt at organization, with inconsistent use of transitions —establish but fail to maintain a formal style, with inconsistent use of language and domain-specific vocabulary —provide a concluding statement or section that follows generally from the topic and information presented	—exhibit little attempt at organization, or attempts to organize are irrelevant to the task —lack a formal style, using language that is imprecise or inappropriate for the text(s) and task —provide a concluding statement or section that is illogical or unrelated to the topic and information presented	—exhibit no evidence of organization —use language that is predominantly incoherent or copied directly from the text(s) —do not provide a concluding statement or section
CONTROL OF CONVENTIONS: the extent to which the essay demonstrates command of the conventions of standard English grammar, usage, capitalization, punctuation, and spelling	W.2 L.1 L.2	—demonstrate grade-appropriate command of conventions, with few errors	—demonstrate grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension	—demonstrate emerging command of conventions, with some errors that may hinder comprehension	—demonstrate a lack of command of conventions, with frequent errors that hinder comprehension	—are minimal, making assessment of conventions unreliable

- If the prompt requires two texts and the student only references one text, the response can be scored no higher than a 2.
- If the student writes only a personal response and makes no reference to the text(s), the response can be scored no higher than a 1.
- Responses totally unrelated to the topic, illegible, or incoherent should be given a 0.
- A response totally copied from the text(s) with no original student writing should be scored a 0.

* Condition Code A is applied whenever a student who is present for a test session leaves an entire constructed-response question in that session completely blank (no response attempted).

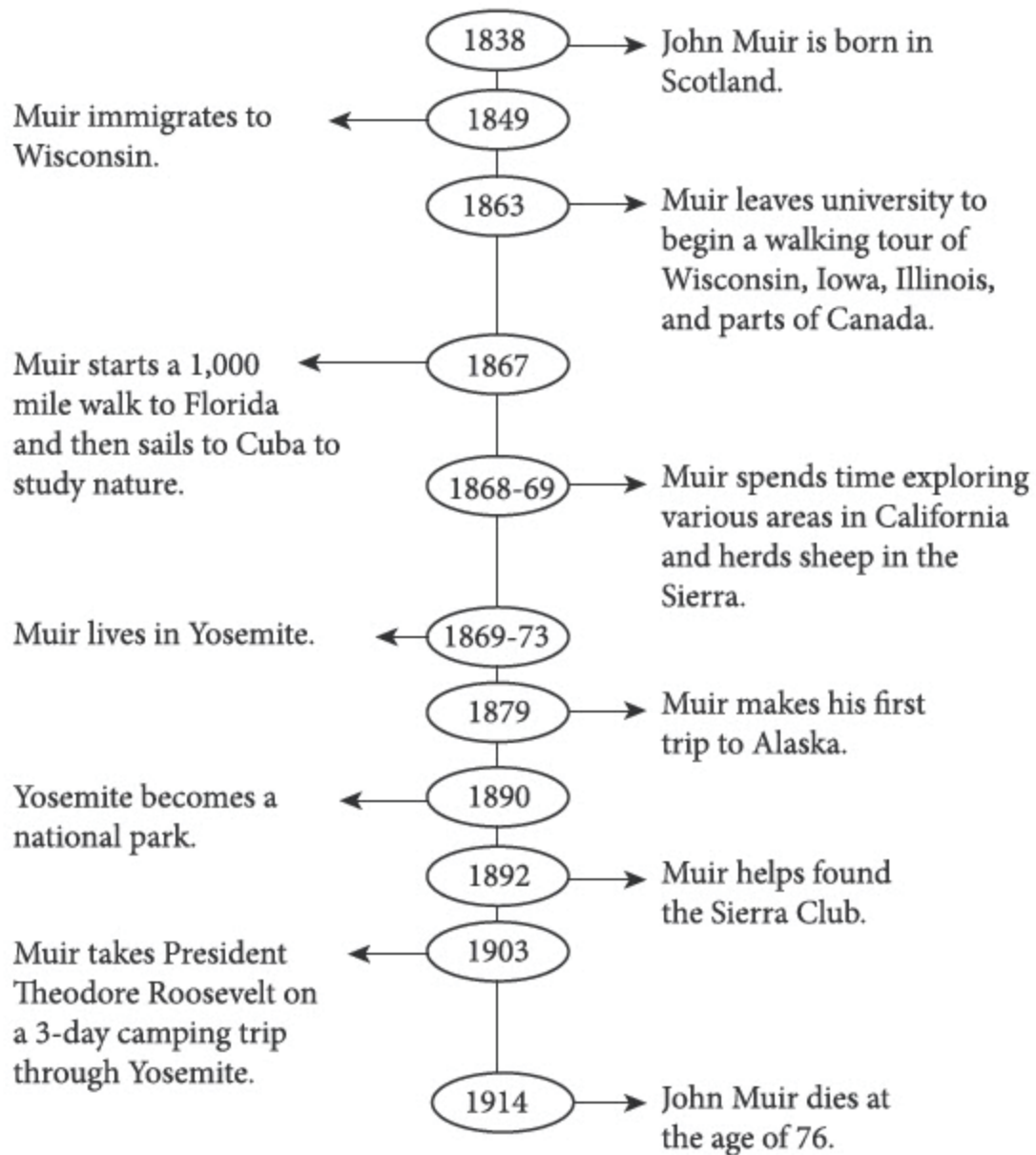
Excerpt from “Man on a Mission”

by Carollyne Hutter

- 1 Every year, about 4 million people from around the world travel to California to see the stunning beauty of Yosemite National Park. The park exists thanks to the efforts of a single man who spent decades fighting to preserve wilderness areas: John Muir. Today, Muir is referred to as “Father of Our National Parks” and is famous as one of America’s first environmentalists. His love of nature and his writings inspired others to take action and protect our nation’s natural places.
- 2 Muir was born on April 21, 1838, in Dunbar, Scotland. When he was 11, his family moved to a small farm in Wisconsin. He worked 16 hours a day on the farm, but he had a tremendous hunger for knowledge. “I loved to read, and I wanted to learn about everything,” he explained. He often read books before he began his chores.
- 3 Although Muir’s formal education ended with his family’s move to Wisconsin, he enrolled in classes at the University of Wisconsin when he was 23 years old. After 2½ years, he became restless and decided to explore the world and study nature instead of staying to graduate. In 1864, he went to Canada for a couple of years and then to Indianapolis, Indiana. While he was working at a carriage factory there in 1867, an accident injured his right eye. He was blind and in pain for weeks. He feared that he would never again see the natural world that he loved.
- 4 In time, Muir’s sight came back. When it did, he decided to devote himself to the study of nature. He left the factory and set off on a 1,000 mile walk to Florida to study plants. The next year, Muir sailed to Cuba and then to San Francisco. From there, he headed eastward to see the wilderness of the Sierra Nevada. He explored Yosemite Valley, located within that mountain range. It was a place that few people visited in those days, and Muir fell in love with its beauty.
- 5 For the rest of his life, Muir was happiest when he was hiking and camping in the mountains. Often, he carried “only a tin cup, a handful of tea, a loaf of bread,” and a journal. He began to offer guided tours in Yosemite in 1870, and in 1871, the *New York Tribune* published his first article about the site’s glaciers.

- 6 Muir spent years studying the area's plants and glaciers. He marveled at Yosemite's majestic waterfalls, massive granite cliffs, and giant sequoia trees. He continued writing about what he saw and learned, and he also gave lectures. His newspaper articles gave him a large audience interested in learning about his experiences.
- 7 In the mid-1800s, railroad, lumber, and mining companies wanted to own or develop any land in the West that might offer a profit. Muir was determined to protect the wilderness he loved from being permanently destroyed by those large industries. . . .
- 8 Muir worked with politicians to make Yosemite and other places be protected by the federal government rather than a state government. On October 1, 1890, Muir and his supporters won a big battle. The US Congress established Yosemite National Park. It was the second national park in the United States—Yellowstone had been carved out of the Wyoming Territory in 1872. Then, in May 1892, Muir and others set up the Sierra Club, an organization of citizens who wanted to protect the entire Sierra Nevada region. Muir was its first president. . . .
- 9 Muir spent the rest of his life exploring nature, writing about it, and fighting to save wilderness areas. His knowledge and his passion about nature made him an influential voice. He did not win every battle, however. He fought for 12 years to save Hetch Hetchy Valley in Yosemite, but in 1913 Congress allowed the site to be dammed to create a reservoir. As one historian later put it, the destruction of that beautiful valley went down in history as “the worst disaster ever to come to any national park.” Yet it is often held up as an example of the importance of preserving natural areas. Today, John Muir's spirit lives on through his writings, the work of the Sierra Club, and the various natural sites that are named for him.

TIMELINE OF JOHN MUIR'S LIFE



EXEMPLARY RESPONSE

28

How does the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” help develop a central idea of the article? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

Possible Exemplary Response:

The timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” helps show how John Muir worked hard to protect nature throughout his life. One important event in the timeline is when “the US Congress established Yosemite National Park” in 1890. This shows how Muir’s efforts helped save a beautiful place. Another key moment is in 1892 when “Muir and others set up the Sierra Club,” which helped protect even more wilderness. These quotes help support the central idea of the article—that John Muir never gave up and made a big difference in saving nature.

Possible Details to Include:

- Other relevant text-based details

Score Credits:

Apply 2-credit holistic rubric.

GUIDE PAPER 1

28 How does the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” help develop a central idea of the article? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

The timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” helps develop a central idea that John Muir loved nature by showing his influence and actions done for nature throughout his life. One detail from the article states, “Muir help found the Sierra Club.” Muir helped found the Sierra Club and became president and the Sierra Club is dedicated to protect the land of nature, and Muir influenced people to join the protection of nature. Another detail from the article states, “Muir starts a 1000 mile walk to Florida and Cuba to study nature.” Muir showed that he loved nature by studying it and taking the time to understand nature, walking over a total of 1000 miles all over the world, proving he loved nature through his actions.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” helps to develop a central idea.

- *by showing his influence and actions done for nature throughout his life*

The response provides evidence of analysis.

- *Muir showed that he loved nature by studying it and taking the time to understand nature, walking over a total of 1000 miles all over the world, proving he loved nature through his actions*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *“Muir help found the Sierra Club.”*
- *became president*
- *Muir influenced people to join the protection of nature*
- *“Muir starts a 1000 mile walk to Florida and Cuba to study nature.”*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

28

How does the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” help develop a central idea of the article? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

The timeline at the end of "Man on a Mission" helps develop a central idea of the article by showing a timeline of events that happend to John Muir and when. The text states Muir and others set up the Sierra Club, an organization of citizens who wanted to protect the entire Sierra Nevada region. Muir was its first president. . . ." The text demonstrates how John Muir made a club called the Sierra Club, to protect the entire Sierra Nevada region, and this also shows it on the timeline. The text states "Muir worked with politicians to make Yosemite and other places be protected by the federal government rather than a state government. On October 1, 1890, Muir and his supporters won a big battle. The US Congress established Yosemite National Park. It was the second national park in the United States— Yellowstone had been carved out of the Wyoming Territory in 1872." The text demonstrates how Muir won a big battle and the US Cingress established Yosemite National Park, this also shows on the timeline. Generally, in passages, the authors will put timelines to show an overview of the events.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” helps to develop a central idea.

- *by showing a timeline of events that happend to John Muir and when*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *Muir and others set up the Sierra Club, an organization of citizens who wanted to protect the entire Sierra Nevada region. Muir was its first president. . . .”*
- *“ Muir worked with politicians to make Yosemite and other places be protected by the federal government rather than a state government. On October 1, 1890, Muir and his supporters won a big battle. The US Congress established Yosemite National Park. It was the second national park in the United States—Yellowstone had been carved out of the Wyoming Territory in 1872.”*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 3

28

How does the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” help develop a central idea of the article? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

The time line at the end helps develop the central idea of the article because. It shows what happened in his life like how in 1892 "Muir helped found the sierra club"and also in 1903 "Muir takes president Theodore Roosevelt on a 3 day camping trip".

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” helps to develop a central idea.

- *It shows what happened in his life*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *in 1892 “Muir helped found the sierra club”*
- *in 1903 “Muir takes president Theodore Roosevelt on a 3 day camping trip”*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 4

28

How does the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” help develop a central idea of the article? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

The timeline at the end of "Man on a Mission" helps develop a central idea of the article by giving a brief summary of it, while giving a bit of extra information. The timeline states that in 1903, John took the current president of that time on a camping trip, however it does not state that in the article. As you can see, the timeline gives a bit more information. It summarizes the article by restating everything that the story says, but making it short and only putting in the most important parts. As you can see, the timeline at the end of this article summarizes the story and gives a few more interesting facts.

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” helps to develop a central idea.

- *by giving a brief summary of it, while giving a bit of extra information*

The response only provides one concrete detail from the text for support.

- *in 1903, John took the current president of that time on a camping trip*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

28

How does the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” help develop a central idea of the article? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

It shows the steps he takes to become a wildlife preserver.

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” helps to develop a central idea.

- *It shows the steps he takes to become a wildlife preserver*

The response does not provide two relevant details from the text for support.

This response includes a complete sentence where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 6

28

How does the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” help develop a central idea of the article? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

He tried to save natinol parks That makes him on a mission

His other mission was to travel the world

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response is a mostly literal recounting of events and details from the passage.

- *He tried to save natinol parks That makes him on a mission His other mission was to travel the world*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 7

28

How does the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” help develop a central idea of the article? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

He fought for 12 years to help save Hetch Hetchy Valley.

In 1913 congress allowed the site to be dammed to create a reservoir.

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *He fought for 12 years to help save Hetch Hetchy Valley. In 1913 congress allowed the site to be dammed to create a reservoir*

28

How does the timeline at the end of “Man on a Mission” help develop a central idea of the article? Include your claim and use **two** details from the article to support your response.

the timeline at the end of the story by "man on a misssion" is thst he "exploring nature writing about is and fighting to save wilderness areas" and also another thing about the story "nature made him an influential voice.

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *the timeline at the end of the story by “man on a misssion” is thst he “exploring nature writing about is and fighting to save wilderness areas” and also another thing about the story “nature made him an influential voice*

Excerpt from *Pig Tales*

by Kate Tym

- 1 Sharon Black had never considered herself an impulsive¹ person until the day she fell in love with a pot-bellied pig! It was 1996 and she'd been doing some reading around the subject of being a pot-bellied pig owner and had very much taken to the idea. She persuaded her somewhat skeptical² husband to drive her over to Oklahoma City and a date with fate was set.
- 2 When she arrived at the house that had three pigs for sale, Sharon knew she wasn't going to leave without one . . . they were all so cute. And when she looked at Peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one.
- 3 Peaches was amazing: she picked up on things so quickly. She was completely house-trained within a few days and soon figured out that the fridge door was the best one to learn how to open! She could get at it with her snout and it soon became clear that anything openable was going to have to be fitted with child-proof locks for as long as Peaches was around!
- 4 Peaches and Sharon have a wonderful time together. As long as Peaches is rested and well fed she's as happy as anything. She loves the pillows on Sharon's couch and if one of them happens to be on the floor she runs up and grabs it with her snout and tosses it up in the air. Then, when it lands on the floor she falls over on it and plays dead; she rolls her eyes up in her head and becomes totally still . . . until someone laughs, then she jumps straight back up and starts the whole routine all over again. She'll keep doing it for ages and ages and then, as soon as she's had enough, she lies down and has a nap.
- 5 Sharon says Peaches is very much like a child and she even hires babysitters for her as there's just too much mischief she could get up to while Sharon's out. She follows Sharon from room to room, curls up to watch TV with her and even sleeps in Sharon's bed!
- 6 One day when Sharon had to leave the house in an emergency, she put Peaches to bed and drew the blinds hoping she would think it was night time and take a quick nap but when Sharon returned home she found Peaches, in the middle of the floor . . . "sobbing!" Peaches was so glad to see Sharon back that she jumped up and smothered her in piggy-love!
- 7 Peaches loves her weekly bath and her favorite snacks for special times are white seedless grapes and apple juice and . . . Pepsi—but only if she manages to get her snout on someone's open can and slurp it down really fast before she gets caught!
- 8 Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words. There is never a dull moment with Peaches around and their relationship is a perfect partnership as Peaches only gives back the love she gets given by having a very special place in a very special household.

¹**impulsive:** acting without thinking

²**skeptical:** unwilling to go along with an idea or action because of worries or doubts

EXEMPLARY RESPONSE

36 In *Pig Tales*, how does the information in paragraph 2 connect with the information in paragraph 8? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

Possible Exemplary Response:

In “Excerpt from *Pig Tales*,” the information in paragraph 2 connects with paragraph 8 by showing how Sharon knew at first sight that Peaches was the pig for her and then later showing that Sharon made the right choice when Sharon describes her life with Peaches. Paragraph 2 states, “And when she looked at Peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one.” This shows how Sharon already bonded Peaches after having only met her. Paragraph 8 states, “Sharon said that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can’t even put it into words.” This demonstrates how Sharon indeed made the right choice and loves Peaches very much.

Possible Details to Include:

- Other relevant text-based details

Score Credits:

Apply 2-credit holistic rubric.

GUIDE PAPER 1

36 In *Pig Tales*, how does the information in paragraph 2 connect with the information in paragraph 8? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The information in Paragraph 2 connects to the information in paragraph 8 by in paragraph 2, she knew that Peaches was the right one and paragraph proves that she was right. In Paragraph 2 it said, "when she looked at peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one"(Paragraph 2). Sharon had a feeling that peaches would be the best one and decided to get peaches. In paragraph 8, it says "peaches has brought so much joy to her life"(Paragraph 8) and "their relationship is a perfect partnership"(Paragraph 8). Peaches and Sharon have a great relationship and gives them so much joy. It shows how her descision in paragraph 2 was right. Therefore, paragraph 2 shows how Sharon knew Peaches was the one and got peaches. Paragraph 8 shows how peaches was the right one and Sharn made the right descision by talking about their relationship and how she brings a lot of joy.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the information in paragraph 2 connects with the information in paragraph 8 of "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*."

- *in paragraph 2, she knew that Peaches was the right one and paragraph proves that she was right*

The response provides evidence of analysis.

- *Sharon had a feeling that peaches would be the best one and decided to get peaches*
- *peaches was the right one and Sharn made the right descision by talking about their relationship and how she brings a lot of joy*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"when she looked at peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one"*
- *"peaches has brought so much joy to her life"*
- *"their relationship is a perfect partnership"*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

36 In *Pig Tales*, how does the information in paragraph 2 connect with the information in paragraph 8? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

the information in paragraph 2 connects to the information in paragraph 8 since paragraph 2 shows the beginning of sharon and peaches relationship and then paragraph 8 shows how that relationship grew. in paragraph 2 it says "they were all so cute. And when she looked at Peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one." and then in paragraph 8 it says "here is never a dull moment with Peaches around and their relationship is a perfect partnership" which shows how the 2 had grown closer over time.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the information in paragraph 2 connects with the information in paragraph 8 of "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*."

- *since paragraph 2 shows the beginning of sharon and peaches relationship and then paragraph 8 shows how that relationship grew*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"they were all so cute. And when she looked at Peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one."*
- *"here is never a dull moment with Peaches around and their relationship is a perfect partnership"*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 3

36

In *Pig Tales*, how does the information in paragraph 2 connect with the information in paragraph 8? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

Both of the paragraphs mention how much she loves Peaches. In the text says, "When she looked at Peaches, she knew she was the one." The text also says, "Peaches has brought so much joy into her life that she can't even put it into words."

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the information in paragraph 2 connects with the information in paragraph 8 of "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*."

- *Both of the paragraphs mention how much she loves Peaches*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"When she looked at Peaches, she knew she was the one."*
- *"Peaches has brought so much joy into her life that she can't even put it into words."*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 4

36 In *Pig Tales*, how does the information in paragraph 2 connect with the information in paragraph 8? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

R- In the passage information from paragrph 2 connects with imformation from paragrpah 8 by explaing how since she laid eyes on Peaches she thought she was special.

A-Sharon knew she wouldnt leave without a pig and being that Peaches was the only girl it really caught her eyes.

C-

E-

C-

E-

R-

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the information in paragraph 2 connects with the information in paragraph 8 of “Excerpt from *Pig Tales*.”

- *by explaing how since she laid eyes on Peaches she thought she was special*

The response only provides one relevant detail from the text for support.

- *Sharon knew she wouldnt leave without a pig and being that Peaches was the only girl it really caught her eyes*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

36

In *Pig Tales*, how does the information in paragraph 2 connect with the information in paragraph 8? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

When she arrived at the house that had three pigs for sale, Sharon knew she wasn't going to leave without one . . . they were all so cute. And when she looked at Peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one. this shows that she cares about them and that she supports the pigs...

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *When she arrived at the house that had three pigs for sale, Sharon knew she wasn't going to leave without one . . . they were all so cute*
- *when she looked at Peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one*

The response does not provide a valid inference from the text to explain how the information in paragraph 2 connects with the information in paragraph 8 of “Excerpt from *Pig Tales*.”

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 6

36 In *Pig Tales*, how does the information in paragraph 2 connect with the information in paragraph 8? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The information in paragraph 2 connects to the information in paragraph 8. In paragraph 2 describes how Sharon got Peaches and how she picked her

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response only provides one relevant detail from the text for support.

- *describes how Sharon got Peaches and how she picked her*

The response does not provide a valid inference from the text to explain how the information in paragraph 2 connects with the information in paragraph 8 of “Excerpt from *Pig Tales*.”

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 7

36 In *Pig Tales*, how does the information in paragraph 2 connect with the information in paragraph 8? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

the information in paragraph 2 connect with the information in paragraph 8 is becasue she seems left out of everyting and it seems like she dosnt have much friends becasue in the text it say for chapter 2 says and I know that becasue in chapter 2 to tell she was happy is what i saw was.

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *the information in paragraph 2 connect with the information in paragraph 8 is becasue she seems left out of everyting and it seems like she dosnt have much friends becasue in the text it say for chapter 2 says and I know that becasue in chapter 2 to tell she was happy is what i saw was*

36 In *Pig Tales*, how does the information in paragraph 2 connect with the information in paragraph 8? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

They go to geather because they both talk about they both talk
About a pig and she was happy in both of them

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *They go to geather because they both talk about they both talk About a pig and she was happy in both of them*

EXEMPLARY RESPONSE

- 37 Some people think that pigs make great pets. How does the author develop this idea in *Pig Tales*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

Possible Exemplary Response:

Some people think that pigs make great pets, and the author of “Except from *Pig Tales*” develops this idea by showing how Peaches is both smart and loving. In paragraph 2, Peaches “was completely house-trained within a few days and soon figured out that the fridge door was the best one to learn how to open!” This shows that pigs can be clever and easy to train. In paragraph 6, when Sharon came home after leaving in an emergency, she found Peaches “sobbing!” and then Peaches “jumped up and smothered her in piggy-love.” This shows that pigs can be very affectionate and form strong bonds with their owners.

Possible Details to Include:

- Other relevant text-based details

Score Credits:

Apply 2-credit holistic rubric.

GUIDE PAPER 1

- 37 Some people think that pigs make great pets. How does the author develop this idea in *Pig Tales*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The author develops the idea that pigs make great pets by showing us the loveing and funny thinkg a pig could do. For example in paragraph 4 it says "As long as Peaches is rested and well fed she's as happy as anything...plays dead; she rolls her eyes up in her head and becomes totally still . . . until someone laughs, then she jumps straight back up and starts the whole routine all over again." this is showing how peaches is happy and a joy to be around. also on paragraph 8 it said "Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words. There is never a dull moment with Peaches around" this is showing that peaches is so loveing and alway brings up you mood just like anyother pet would.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the author of "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*" develops the idea that some people think pigs make great pets.

- *by showing us the loveing and funny thinkg a pig could do*

The response provides evidence of analysis.

- *this is showing how peaches is happy and a joy to be around*
- *showing that peaches is so loveing and alway brings up you mood just like anyother pet would*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"As long as Peaches is rested and well fed she's as happy as anything...plays dead; she rolls her eyes up in her head and becomes totally still . . . until someone laughs, then she jumps straight back up and starts the whole routine all over again."*
- *"Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words. There is never a dull moment with Peaches around"*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

- 37 Some people think that pigs make great pets. How does the author develop this idea in *Pig Tales*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

people think pigs are great pets the way the author develops this idea because they are so loveable and very well trained. Reason one is "As long Peaches is rested and well fed she's happy as anyhting. She loves the pillows on Sharon's couch if one of them happens to be beone the floor she runs up and grabs it with her snout tosses it up in the air. Then, when it lands on the floor she falls over on it and plays dead; she rolls her eyes in the back of her head and becomes tottaly silly . . . until someone laughs the she jumps back up and starts the whole routine all over agin. She'll keep doing it for ages and ages and then, as soon she had enough, she lies down and has a nap". That helps out my claim because she so playful and she loves playing to make pepole laugh showing thats shoing she loves them. my second reason why is." Peaches was amazing: she picked up on things so quickly. She was completely house-trained within a few days and soon figured out that the fridge door was he best one to learn how to open! She could get at it wiht her snout and it soon became clear that anything openable was going to haveto be fitted with child-proof locks for as long as Peaches was around!". That helps my claim because how smart she is they had to put kid-proof locks on everything.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the author of "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*" develops the idea that some people think pigs make great pets.

- *because they are so loveable and very well trained*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"As long Peaches is rested and well fed she's happy as anyhting. She loves the pillows on Sharon's couch if one of them happens to be beone the floor she runs up and grabs it with her snout tosses it up in the air. Then, when it lands on the floor she falls over on it and plays dead; she rolls her eyes in the back of her head and becomes tottaly silly . . . until someone laughs the she jumps back up and starts the whole routine all over agin. She'll keep doing it for ages and ages and then, as soon she had enough, she lies down and has a nap"*
- *"Peaches was amazing: she picked up on things so quickly. She was completely house-trained within a few days and soon figured out that the fridge door was he best one to learn how to open! She could get at it wiht her snout and it soon became clear that anything openable was going to haveto be fitted with child-proof locks for as long as Peaches was around!"*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 3

- 37 Some people think that pigs make great pets. How does the author develop this idea in *Pig Tales*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The author develop's this idea by using positive information about Peaches such as "As long as Peaches is rested and well fed she's as happy as anything", and "Peaches was amazing: she picked up on things so quickly."

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the author of "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*" develops the idea that some people think pigs make great pets.

- *by using positive information about Peaches*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"As long as Peaches is rested and well fed she's as happy as anything"*
- *"Peaches was amazing: she picked up on things so quickly."*

This response includes a complete sentence where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 4

- 37 Some people think that pigs make great pets. How does the author develop this idea in *Pig Tales*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

The author develop the idea by describing how it is like to have a pig.
In the text it say "peaches andd sharon have a wondful time together.as long as peaches is rested and well and fed she's happy as anything".

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain how the author of “Excerpt from *Pig Tales*” develops the idea that some people think pigs make great pets.

- *by describing how it is like to have a pig*

The response only provides one concrete detail from the text for support.

- *“peaches andd sharon have a wondful time together.as long as peaches is rested and well and fed she’s happy as anything”*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

- 37 Some people think that pigs make great pets. How does the author develop this idea in *Pig Tales*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

She develops this idea with the fact that the author says how Sharon thought "There is never a dull moment with peaches around" from p8 sentence 2 and "She was completely house-trained with in a few days" p3 sentence 2.

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *"There is never a dull moment with peaches around"*
- *"She was completely house-trained with in a few days"*

The response does not provide a valid inference from the text to explain how the author of "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*" develops the idea that some people think pigs make great pets.

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 6

- 37 Some people think that pigs make great pets. How does the author develop this idea in *Pig Tales*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

sharon says that peaches has brought so much joy life thal. only girl bunch ,she knew she was the one. to oklahoma city and a date with fate was set.

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response only provides one concrete detail from the text for support.

- *sharon says that peaches has brought so much joy*

The response does not provide a valid inference from the text to explain how the author of “Excerpt from *Pig Tales*” develops the idea that some people think pigs make great pets.

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 7

- 37** Some people think that pigs make great pets. How does the author develop this idea in *Pig Tales*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

I think that the athour developes the idea because this story is about a girl who gets a pet pug and cares for it.And also I think that the author is trying to show that pigs can be pets from the artical.

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *I think that the athour developes the idea because this story is about a girl who gets a pet pug and cares for it.And also I think that the author is trying to show that pigs can be pets from the artical*

- 37 Some people think that pigs make great pets. How does the author develop this idea in *Pig Tales*? Include your claim and use **two** details from the story to support your response.

They menchound how she was not going to leave with out a big. another detail is how she fell in love at first ight.

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *They menchound how she was not going to leave with out a big. another detail is how she fell in love at first ight*

We Keep a Pig in the Parlor

by Suzanne Bloom

Some people keep pigs in a pigpen,
Or out in a field roaming free.
We keep a pig in the parlor.
He sleeps on the settee.¹

5 He used to live in the pig barn,
And sit looking out at the field,
 Till a plan took shape
 For a great escape,
“I want to be free,” he squealed.

10 He fairly flew out of the window,
With a run and a jump and a grunt.
 He came down in the mud
 With a squishy, soft thud,
It was quite an incredible stunt.

15 He wandered way out to the pasture
In search of some company.
“I just want a friend to spend time with,”
He said, grinning sheepishly.²

We pitched him back in the pig barn,
20 Tail over snout over heels.
A pen made of pine
Is just fine for a swine,
No matter how loudly he squeals.

Outside he heard quizzical quacking
25 And finding a large enough crack
Between two loose boards
That rattled like gourds,³
He squeezed himself out of that shack.

The zucchini and peas looked so tempting
30 And the broccoli grew in great clumps.
His tummy felt ever so empty.
He ate everything but the stumps.

You know, pig, you're driving me crazy.
Why are you doing this stuff?
35 The garden and barn are a terrible mess.
Enough is enough is enough!

He looked at me sadly and mumbled,
"I'm sorry I've been such a pest."

Then he snorted and said,
40 "I detest a straw bed,
Corn that's unpopped
Supper called slop.
Mud on my face,
that ramshackle⁴ place.
45 It makes me disgruntled,⁵ at best.

Besides," he said, "I'm so lonesome,"
And he rested his head on my knee.
As I hugged him I had an idea.
"Piggy, cheer up. Follow me."

50 So, we keep our pig in the parlor;
He sleeps on the settee.
We watch TV,
Have popcorn and tea
As cozy as we can be.

¹**settee:** sofa

²**sheepishly:** in an embarrassed way

³**gourds:** the shells of dried fruit with seeds inside

⁴**ramshackle:** broken down

⁵**disgruntled:** unhappy, upset

EXEMPLARY RESPONSE

- 38** What does the phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* suggest about the pig? Include your claim and use **two** details from the poem to support your response.

Possible Exemplary Response:

The phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of “*We Keep a Pig in the Parlor*” suggests that the pig is bold, energetic, and full of personality. The poem says he “fairly flew out of the window, / With a run and a jump and a grunt,” which shows that the pig didn’t just escape—he did it with dramatic flair. Then, “He came down in the mud / With a squishy, soft thud,” which adds humor and shows that his actions were surprising and a little wild. These details help the reader see the pig as more than just a farm animal—he’s adventurous and determined to live life his own way.

Possible Details to Include:

- Other relevant text-based details

Score Credits:

Apply 2-credit holistic rubric.

GUIDE PAPER 1a

- 38** What does the phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* suggest about the pig? Include your claim and use **two** details from the poem to support your response.

The phrase "incredible stunt" in line 14 of "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" suggests that the pig would do anything for some sense of belonging, friendship, and freedom, even if it requires a stunt like the one described in the poem. For example, to demonstrate the depiction of this impressive stunt, Suzanne Bloom, the author of this poem, writes that, "He [the pig] fairly flew out of the window . . . It was quite an incredible stunt." (lines 10-14). We can see that with some context, the pig wanted to have freedom. Therefore, the pig's unbelievable determination definitely helped him achieve this freedom, hence stating that the pig is desperate for the new amount of respect that he expects for someone to give to him. Additionally, to demonstrate how all of this allowed the pig to have his desired freedom, Bloom also writes that the pig "detested a straw bed" and was "so lonesome," hence convincing the owner to "keep [the] pig in the parlor." (lines 40-50). As the poem develops, it is easy to see that since the pig performed that "incredible stunt," as depicted in line 14, when the owner finds him, it is clear that the owner finds out that the pig wants belonging and friendship more than anything else in the world. This allows the owner to give the pig some more freedom in the parlor, marking the end of the poem. In conclusion, the "incredible stunt" demonstrates how desperate the pig is to get these two senses of belonging and friendship, hence allowing him to get his ultimate freedom.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain what the phrase “incredible stunt” suggests about the pig in line 14 of “*We Keep a Pig in the Parlor*.”

- *the pig would do anything for some sense of belonging, friendship, and freedom*

The response provides evidence of analysis.

- *We can see that with some context, the pig wanted to have freedom. Therefore, the pig’s unbelievable determination definitely helped him achieve this freedom, hence stating that the pig is desperate for the new amount of respect that he expects for someone to give to him*
- *to demonstrate how all of this allowed the pig to have his desired freedom*
- *it is clear that the owner finds out that the pig wants belonging and friendship more than anything else in the world. This allows the owner to give the pig some more freedom in the parlor*

GUIDE PAPER 1b

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *“He [the pig] fairly flew out of the window . . . It was quite an incredible stunt.”*
- *“detested a straw bed”*
- *“so lonesome,”*
- *convincing the owner to “keep [the] pig in the parlor.”*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

- 38** What does the phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* suggest about the pig? Include your claim and use **two** details from the poem to support your response.

This suggests that the pig is very lively and full of energy. I know this because on line 10 the text says "He fairly flew out of the window, With a run and a jump and a grunt." This shows that the pig is lively and full of energy. another detail is on line 28 the text says "He squeezed himself out of that shack." This shows that the pig is very lively and full of energy.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain what the phrase “incredible stunt” suggests about the pig in line 14 of “*We Keep a Pig in the Parlor*.”

- *This suggests that the pig is very lively and full of energy*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *“He fairly flew out of the window, With a run and a jump and a grunt.”*
- *“He squeezed himself out of that shack.”*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 3

- 38** What does the phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* suggest about the pig? Include your claim and use **two** details from the poem to support your response.

the frase in the parlor incredibale stunt it means how impresive movement that the pig did to be free in the text it says "he came down in the mud with squishy soft thud it was an incredible stunt" this detail shows that the pig thought it was an amazing stunt that he did. another detail is " "he fairly flew out the window with a run and a jump and a grunt " this shows that he though that his trick was inpresive.

Score Credit 2 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain what the phrase “incredible stunt” suggests about the pig in line 14 of “*We Keep a Pig in the Parlor*.”

- *the frase ment that the pig thought the trick he did was inpresive*

The response provides a sufficient number of concrete details from the text for support as required by the prompt.

- *“he came down in the mud with squishy soft thud it was an incredible stunt”*
- *“ “he fairly flew out the window with a run and a jump and a grunt ”*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 4

- 38** What does the phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* suggest about the pig? Include your claim and use **two** details from the poem to support your response.

The phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of “We Keep a Pig in the Parlor” suggests about the pig that the pig was so exited to be free. In line 9 it states “ I want to be free,” he squealed. This shows that the Pig wants to leave his barn. This reveals that the Pig is so bored and devastated to b locked up in the barn. In line 14 it states “ It was a quite an incredible stunt” This shows that the pig was very exited to come out and run/jump. The reveals that the pig had so many energy to play around outside for the first time. In conclusion the phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of “We Keep a Pig in the Parlor” suggests about the pig that the pig was so exited to be free.

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain what the phrase “incredible stunt” suggests about the pig in line 14 of “*We Keep a Pig in the Parlor*.”

- *the pig was so exited to be free*

The response only provides one concrete detail from the text for support.

- “ *I want to be free,*” he squealed

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

- 38 What does the phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* suggest about the pig? Include your claim and use **two** details from the poem to support your response.

That it was a good and a shocking trick he did.

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response provides a valid inference from the text to explain what the phrase “incredible stunt” suggests about the pig in line 14 of “*We Keep a Pig in the Parlor*.”

- *it was a good and a shocking trick he did*

The response does not provide two relevant details from the text for support.

This response includes a complete sentence where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 6

- 38** What does the phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* suggest about the pig? Include your claim and use **two** details from the poem to support your response.

"He fairly flew out of the window,
With a run and a jump and a grunt.
He came down in the mud
With a squishy, soft thud,
It was quite an incredible stunt."

Score Credit 1 (out of 2 credits)

This response only provides one concrete detail from the text for support.

- *"He fairly flew out of the window, With a run and a jump and a grunt. He came down in the mud With a squishy, soft thud, It was quite an incredible stunt."*

The response does not provide a valid inference from the text to explain what the phrase “incredible stunt” suggests about the pig in line 14 of *“We Keep a Pig in the Parlor.”*

This response includes complete sentences where errors do not impact readability.

GUIDE PAPER 7

- 38 What does the phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* suggest about the pig? Include your claim and use **two** details from the poem to support your response.

"incredible stunt". It means to do stunt and you can do it if you want to its a good talent you can have fun but it could be dangrous you ca do it with a bike fire scooters etc.

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- “*incredible stunt*”. It means to do stunt and you can do it if you want to its a good talent you can have fun but it could be dangrous you ca do it with a bike fire scooters etc.

- 38 What does the phrase “incredible stunt” in line 14 of *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* suggest about the pig? Include your claim and use **two** details from the poem to support your response.

they ceep him there so he can sleep thar and play and he does not eat all the food in house
and he can not escape

Score Credit 0 (out of 2 credits)

This response does not address any of the requirements of the prompt.

- *they ceep him there so he can sleep thar and play and he does not eat all the food in house and he can not escape*

EXEMPLARY RESPONSE

39 The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal grey lines, resembling notebook paper. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There is no handwriting or other markings on the paper.

Possible Exemplary Response:

In both “Excerpt from *Pig Tales*” by Kate Tym and “*We Keep a Pig in the Parlor*” by Suzanne Bloom, the pigs have strong relationships with their owners. These relationships are filled with love, humor, and challenges. While both pigs are treated like part of the family, the way each owner responds to the pig’s behavior is a little different. These relationships help move the plot forward by showing how the pigs change the lives of the people around them.

In “Excerpt from *Pig Tales*,” Sharon treats Peaches like her child. She says Peaches is “very much like a child” and even hires babysitters for her. Peaches follows Sharon around the house, watches TV with her, and sleeps in her bed. Their close bond is shown when Sharon returns home and finds Peaches “sobbing!” because she missed her. This emotional connection helps move the story forward by showing how Peaches becomes a central part of Sharon’s life and brings her much joy.

In “*We Keep a Pig in the Parlor*,” the pig also has a strong bond with the narrator, but it starts with trouble. The pig escapes from the barn in what the narrator calls an “incredible stunt,” and causes chaos in the garden. At first, the narrator is frustrated and says, “Enough is enough is enough!” But when the pig says, “I’m so lonesome,” and rests his head on the narrator’s knee, the mood changes. The narrator hugs him and says, “Piggy, cheer up. Follow me.” This moment shows how the plot takes a turn as their relationship grows from frustration to understanding, and it leads to the pig becoming part of the family, sleeping on the settee and watching TV.

Both relationships are similar because the pigs are treated like family members and are loved deeply. However, they are different in how they begin. Sharon’s relationship with Peaches is loving from the start, while the narrator in the poem learns to love the pig after dealing with his mischief. In both cases, the bond between pig and owner helps move the plot forward—from adoption to acceptance, and from chaos to companionship.

Possible Details to Include:

- Other relevant text-based details

Score Credits:

Apply 4-credit holistic rubric.

GUIDE PAPER 1a

39

The pigs in "Excerpt from Pig Tales" and "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from both the story and the poem to support your response. [4]

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from both the story and the poem to support your response

Having ~~connections~~ relationships are always the best way to advance. "Excerpt from Pig Tales" by Kate Tynnis is about a pig named Peaches living and sharing a bond with Sharon Black. "We Keep a Pig in the parlor" by Suzanne Bloom is about a pig being disgruntled because the pig is trapped inside but wants a friend, so the pig does bad things to escape but ends up becoming friends with the owner. The pigs in "Excerpt from Pig Tales" and "We keep a pig in a parlor" share similarities and differences relationships that help advance the plot. The pigs in "Excerpt from Pig Tales" and "We keep a pig in a parlor" share similarities. One example is "We watch TV, I have popcorn

GUIDE PAPER 1b

and tea / As soon as we can be (5). This proves that the owner and pig have a good relationship that they can both share. Another text evidence according to "Except from Pig Tales" is, "Peach has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words" (8). This clearly shows the love between pig and human, they have had so much fun together that they can't even put it to words, just like the pig and human from "We Keep a Pig in a Parlor". Overall, friendships make one's life better.

The pigs and owners from "Except from Pig Tales" and "We Keep a Pig in a Parlor" share differences. According to "Except from Pig Tales" it states "she was completely house-trained within a few days and soon figured out that the fridge door was the best one to learn how to open!" (3). This statement proves that this pig is well trained and behaved unlike the pig in "We Keep a Pig in a Parlor" who even tries to escape. Another piece of evidence

GUIDE PAPER 1c

according to "We keep a Pig in a Parlor" is "Some people keep pig in a pigpen, / Or out in a field roaming free / We keep a pig in a parlor. / He sleeps on the settee" (0). This piece of evidence proves that this pig owner does not treat their pig right, and keeps them in a bad area, unlike the pig in "Excerpt from Pig Tales" who sleeps on the owner's bed, huge difference! Overall, always treat friends like your life depends on it. 1-1

The owners and pigs in "We keep a Pig in a Parlor" and "Excerpt from Pig Tales" have relationships that help advance the plot. One piece of evidence according to "We keep a Pig in a Parlor" is, when the conflict was resolved "we watch TV, / Have popcorn and tea / as cozy as we can be" (50). This proves that because of the pig and human being able to become friends, changed the plot, if they hadn't become friends the problem wouldn't be solved. Another piece of evidence according to "Excerpt from Pig Tales" is, "Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words" (8). This text evidence proves without the love of Sharon given to her pig, the whole plot would be different, they wouldn't even be an excerpt. Overall, friendship is powerful.

GUIDE PAPER 1d

Score Credit 4 (out of 4 credits)

This response clearly introduces a topic in a manner that is compelling and follows logically from the task and purpose.

- *Having companionships are always the best way to advance. "Excerpt from Pig Tales" by Kate Tymis is about a pig named Peaches living and sharing a bond with Sharon Black. "We Keep a Pig in the parlor" by Suzanne Bloom is about a pig being disgruntled because the pig is trapped inside but wants a friend, so the pig does bad things to escape but ends up becoming friends with the owner. The pigs and owners in "Excerpt from Pig Tales" and "We keep a Pig in a Parlor" share similarities and differences relationships that help advance the plot*

The response demonstrates insightful analysis of the texts.

- *the owner and pig have a good relationship that they can both share*
- *the love between pig and human*
- *they have had so much fun together that they cant even put it to words*
- *friendships make one's life better*
- *this pig is well trained and behaved unlike the pig in "We keep a Pig in a Parlor" who even tries to escape*
- *that this pig owner does not treat their pig right, and keeps them in a bad area unlike the pig in "Excerpt from Pig Tales" who sleeps on the owners bed a huge difference*
- *always treat friends like one's life depends on it*
- *This proves that because of the pig and the human being able to become friends, changed the plot, if they hadn't become friends the problem wouldn't be solved*
- *without the love of Sharon given to her pig, the whole plot would be different. They wouldn't even be an excerpt*

The response develops the topic with relevant, well-chosen details from the texts, and sustains the use of varied, relevant evidence.

- *"We watch TV./ Have popcorn and tea / As cozy as we can be"*
- *"Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she cant even put it into words"*
- *"she was completely house trained within a few days and soon figured out that the fridge door was the best one to learn how to open"*
- *"Some people keep pigs in a pig pen, / or out in a field roaming free / We keep a pig in a parlor. / He sleeps on the settee"*
- *when the conflict was resolved "we watch TV. / Have popcorn and tea/ as cozy as we can be!"*
- *"Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she cant even put into words"*

The response exhibits clear organization, with the skillful use of appropriate and varied transitions to create a unified whole and enhance meaning.

- *One example in "We keep a pig in a parlor"*
- *This proves that*
- *Another text evidence according to "Excerpt from Pig Tales"*
- *This clearly shows*
- *just like the pig and human from "We keep a pig in a Parlor"*
- *Overall*

GUIDE PAPER 1e

- *According to “Excerpt from Pig Tales” it states*
- *This statement proves that [...] unlike*
- *This piece of evidence proved that*
- *One piece of evidence according to “We keep a Pig in a Parlor”*
- *Another piece of evidence*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.

The response provides a concluding statement that follows from the topic and information presented.

- *Overall, friendship is powerful*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with few errors.

- *similarities*
- *cant*
- *owners bed*
- Capitalization

39

The pigs in "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*" and "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response. [4]

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

The relationships between the pigs and the owners in "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*" and "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" are both very healthy and wholesome. Both owners are dear friends with their pigs. In "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*", Peaches, the pig, missed her owner dearly and was happy to see her return. "Peaches was so glad to see Sharon back that she jumped up and smothered her in piggy love" (paragraph 6). In "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor", in order to comfort their pig, the owner hugs them. "And he rested his head on my knee. As I hugged him I had an idea." (paragraph 11). But at the same time, these relationships are different. In "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*", Sharon is actively amused by Peaches's antics and doesn't punish her. But in "We Keep a Pig in the

Parlor", the owner gets constantly fed up by their pig's antics and has them moved. "You know, pig, you're driving me crazy. Why are you doing this stuff? The garden and barn are a terrible mess. Enough is enough is enough" (lines 33-36).

The special relationships the owners have with their pigs help advance the plot in both the story and the poem by comparing the relationships at the start to the end. In "Excerpt from Pig Tales", the lovable relationship between Sharon and Peaches advances the plot through strengthening their relationship. Before, she chose Peaches as her pig because she was adorable and female. But at the end, Sharon says, "...their relationship is a perfect partnership as Peaches only gives back the love she gets given by having a very special place in a very special household" (paragraph 8).

As for "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor", their relationship advances the plot by being strengthened as well. At the start, they keep him in a pen and are constantly mad at the pig. But in the end, he now enjoys the life in the owner's house, their "parlor". "So, we keep our pig in the parlor; he sleeps on the settee. [...] As cozy as we can be" (lines 50, 51, 54). In conclusion, the relationships between the pigs and owners are very special, yet similar at the same time.

Score Credit 4 (out of 4 credits)

This response clearly introduces a topic in a manner that is compelling and follows logically from the task and purpose.

- *The relationships between the pigs and the owners in "Excerpt from Pig Tales" and "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" are both very healthy and wholesome. Both owners are dear friends with their pigs*

The response demonstrates insightful analysis of the texts.

- *Both owners are dear friends with their pigs*
- *Peaches, the pig, missed her owner dearly and was happy to see her return*
- *in order to comfort their pig, the owner hugs them*
- *Sharon is actively amused by Peaches's antics and does not punish her. But in "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor", the owner gets constantly fed up by their pig's antics and has them moved*
- *The special relationships the owners have with their pigs help advance the plot in both the story and the poem by comparing the relationships at the start to the end [...] the lovable relationship between Sharon and Peaches advances the plot through strengthening their relationship [...] she chose Peaches as her pig because she was adorable and female*
- *their relationship advances the plot by being strengthened as well. At the start, they keep him in a pen and are constantly mad at the pig. But in the end, he now enjoys the life in the owner's house, their "parlor"*

The response develops the topic with relevant, well-chosen details from the texts, and sustains the use of varied, relevant evidence.

- *"Peaches was so glad to see Sharon back that she jumped up and smothered her in piggy love"*
- *"And he rested his head on my knee. As I hugged him I had an idea."*
- *"You know pig, you're driving me crazy. Why are you doing this stuff? The garden and barn are a terrible mess. Enough is enough is enough"*
- *"...their relationship is a perfect partnership as Peaches only gives back the love she gets given by having a very special place in a very special household"*
- *"So, we keep our pig in the parlor; he sleeps on the settee. [...] As cozy as we can be"*

The response exhibits clear organization, with the skillful use of appropriate and varied transitions to create a unified whole and enhance meaning.

- *In "Excerpt from Pig Tales*
- *But at the same time*
- *both the story and the poem*
- *by comparing*
- *Before [...] But at the end*
- *As for "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor"*
- *At the start [...] But in the end*
- *In conclusion*
- *at the same time*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style, using grade-appropriate, stylistically sophisticated language and domain-specific vocabulary with a notable sense of voice.

- *amused by Peaches's antics*

The response provides a concluding statement that is compelling and follows clearly from the topic and information presented.

- *In conclusion, the relationships between the pigs and owners are very special, yet similar at the same time*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with few errors.

GUIDE PAPER 3a

39

The pigs in "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*" and "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response. [4]

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

In "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*" and "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor," both stories develop and describe the great love between owner and pet, in this case owner and pig. Both passages though, describe this love differently, but both focus on the topic. In this essay, I will explain similarities and differences and explain how relationships in both passages help to advance in the plot of the story/poem.

Both "Excerpt from *Pig Tales*" and "We keep a pig in the parlor," express owner-pet relationships. By this I mean, in each reading, a great love is depicted between an owner and their

GUIDE PAPER 3b

para. "Excerpt from Pig Tales states 'There is none a dull moment with Peaches around and their relationship is a perfect partnership as Peaches only gives back the love she gets given by having a very special place in a very special home.' This detail describes how Peaches and Sharon have a very special and loving relationship with each other, describing the owner-pet relationship. "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" states "So, we keep our pig in the parlor; He sleeps on the settee. We watch TV, Have popcorn and tea As cozy as we can be." This detail uses the words "As cozy as we can be" to describe the relationship with the owner and pet, which shows that both the owner and pet are cozy together, showing they love to have a special bond.

Though both "Excerpt from Pig Tales" and "We Keep a pig in the Parlor" seem to have lots in common, they too have their differences. In "Excerpt from Pig Tales, Peaches is willingly adopted and happiness runs all the way through, while in

GUIDE PAPER 3c

"We Keep a Pig in the Parlor, the pig let runs away, and meets up with the owner, and happiness starts there." "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" states "Besides" he, said, "I'm so handsome" and he ~~rested~~ his head on my knee. As I hugged him I had an idea. "Piggie, cheer up. Follow me." So, we keep our pig in the Parlor, he sleeps on the settee. We watch TV, have popcorn and tea. As crazy as we can be." This detail shows how the pig acts off negatively, and once owners and pet meet, there is a flow of happiness. "Except from Pig Tales" states, "Peaches and Shamen have a wonderful time together. As long as Peaches is ~~needed~~ well fed she's as happy as any sheep." This detail shows that in "Except from Pig Tales", happiness runs all the way throughout the entire story.

In "Except from Pig Tales" and "We Keep a pig in the Parlor", both stories develop an owner-pet relationship as soon as they meet, and from there, it runs through the end of the passages. In "Except from Pig Tales", the text states "And when she looked at Peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one." This shows that as soon as Shamen and Peaches' eyes meet, they know they were meant for each other. In "We keep a pig in the Parlor" the text states "Piggie, cheer up. Follow me." So we keep our pig in the parlor, he sleeps on the settee. We watch TV, have popcorn and tea. As crazy as we can be." This detail too develops the story, as soon as owner and pet met, there was instant happiness.

In conclusion, both, "We keep a pig in the Parlor" and "Except from: Pig Tales". Both tell the story of an owner-pet relationship, but describe it differently. In the end though, there is great love between one, and one's pig.

GUIDE PAPER 3d

Score Credit 4 (out of 4 credits)

This response clearly introduces a topic in a manner that is compelling and follows logically from the task and purpose.

- *In “Excerpt from Pig Tales and “We Keep a Pig in the Parlor, both stories develop and describe the great love between owner and pet, in this case owner and pig. Both passages though, describe this love deffertly, but both focus on the topic. In this essay, I will explain similarities and differences and explain how relationships in both passages help to advance the plot of the story /poem*

The response demonstrates insightful analysis of the texts.

- *in each reading a great love is depicted between an owner and their pig*
- *Peaches and Sharon have a very special and loving relationship with each other describing the owner-pet relationship*
- *This detail uses the words “As cozy as can be,” to describe the relationship with the owner and the pet “we” shows that both the owner and the pet are cozy together, showing they have a special bond*
- *Peaches is willingly adopted and happiness was all the way through, while in “We Keep a Pig in the Parlor, the pig first runs away and meets up with the owner and happiness starts there*
- *the pig starts off negative and once owner and pet meet, there is a flood of happiness*
- *happiness runs all the way throughout the entire story*
- *both stories develop an owner- pet relationship as soon as they meet and from there it runs through the end of the passages*
- *as soon as Sharon and Peaches’ eyes met, they knew they were meant for each other*
- *as soon as owner and pet met there was instant happiness*

The response develops the topic with relevant details from the texts, and sustains the use of relevant evidence, with some lack of variety.

- *“There never a dull moment with Peaches around and their relationship is a perfect partnership as Peaches only gives back the love she gets giving by having a very special place in a very special home.”*
- *“so, we keep our pig in the parlor; he sleeps on the settee. We watch TV, Have popcorn and tea As cozy as can be.”*
- *“Besides” he, said, “I’m so lonesome,” he laid his head on my knee. As I hugged him I had an idea. “Piggy, cheer up. Follow me.”*
- *“Peaches and Sharon have a wonderful time together. As long as Peaches is rested and well fed she’s as happy as anything.”*
- *“And when she looked at Peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one.”*

The response exhibits clear organization, with the skillful use of appropriate and varied transitions to create a unified whole and enhance meaning.

- *Both “Exerpt from Pig Tales and “We Keep a Pig in the Parlor*
- *By this I mean*
- *“Exerpt from Pig Tales states*
- *This detail describes*
- *Though both*
- *In “Exurpt from Pig Tales [...] while in “We Keep a Pig in the Parlor*
- *This detail shows*

GUIDE PAPER 3e

- *both stories develop*
- *This shows*
- *the text states*
- *This detail too develops*
- *In conclusion*
- *In the end though*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style, using grade-appropriate, stylistically sophisticated language and domain-specific vocabulary with a notable sense of voice.

- *owner-pet relationships*
- *depicted*
- *flood of happiness*

The response provides a concluding statement that is compelling and follows clearly from the topic and information presented.

- *In conclusion, both, “We have a pig in the Parlor” and Exerpt from: Pig Tales. Both tell the story of a story owner- pet relationship, but describe it differtly. In the end though, there is great love between one, and one’s pig*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with few errors.

- *deffertly*
- *Exerpt*
- Capitalization
- Punctuation

GUIDE PAPER 4a

39 The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

The pigs in Tym's and Bloom's stories describes the experience of taking in a pig in seeking for a friend, however the way that their relationships go is drastically different. Because of this difference, it causes a phenomenal relationship to develop in Tym's excerpt, while it causes a problematic but also caring relationship in Bloom's excerpt. This can be seen in Tym's excerpt, when Sharon is entirely satisfied and pleased with her pig (Peaches).

For instance, in Tym's excerpt, when Sharon describes her experience with Peaches, "Peaches and Sharon have a wonderful time together...happy as anything." Sharon describes her experience as this wonderful journey that makes both of them "happy as anything". Tym uses words such as "a wonderful time together", to describe their phenomenal and exceptional relationship. Another instance, in Tym's excerpt, when Sharon describes the happiness that Peaches has brought to her, "Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words." Sharon gets so overwhelmed with happiness and joy, that Tym describes this experience as "she can't even put it into words". Tym uses words such as "brought so much joy to her life", to express their great and phenomenal relationship. However, this relationship between the narrator and the pig becomes much more problematic.

GUIDE PAPER 4b

For instance, in Bloom's excerpt, when the narrator describes her experience with her pig, "You know, pig, you're driving me crazy...It makes me disgruntled." The narrator describes this problematic relationship as it disturbs and causes great stress and severe issues that anger the narrator. Bloom uses words such as "makes me disgruntled", to demonstrate their severe problematic relationship. However, despite this, the narrator takes this experience and describes how he had become caring towards the pig. Another instance, in Bloom's excerpt, when the narrator reflects on this experience, "'Piggy, cheer up. Follow me'...He sleeps on the settee...cozy as we can be." The narrator takes this experience to reflect to bond to make a phenomenal relationship, rather than a problematic relationship. Bloom uses words such as "'Piggy, cheer up'", to demonstrate the narrator developing a caring and loving relationship by bonding with the pig.

Both excerpts go over how the narrator bonds with the pig, however they do this both in explicitly different ways. In Tym's article, the narrator successfully bonds with the pig, making a phenomenal relationship, while in Bloom's article, the narrator fails to do so. However the narrator reflects on this, which changes the plot to severely advance making character development but also a successful relationship at both the end of the story and poem.

Score Credit 3 (out of 4 credits)

This response introduces a topic in a manner that follows generally from the task and purpose.

- *The pigs in Tym's and Bloom's stories describes the experience of taking in a pig in seeking for a friend, however the way that their relationships go is drastically different. Because of this difference, it causes a phenomenal relationship to develop in Tym's excerpt, while it causes a problematic but also caring relationship in Bloom's excerpt*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate analysis of the texts.

- *Sharon is entirely satisfied and pleased with her pig (Peaches)*
- *Sharon describes her experience as this wonderful journey that makes both of them "happy as anything"*
- *words such as "a wonderful time together", to describe their phenomenal and exceptional relationship*
- *Sharon gets so overwhelmed with happiness and joy*
- *The narrator describes this problematic relationship as it disturbs and causes great stress and severe issues that anger the narrator*
- *words such as "makes me disgruntled", to demonstrate their severe problematic relationship*
- *The narrator takes this experience to reflect to bond to make a phenomenal relationship, rather than a problematic relationship*
- *the narrator reflects on this, which changes the plot to severely advance making character development but also a successful relationship at both the end of the story and poem*

GUIDE PAPER 4c

The response develops the topic with relevant, well-chosen details from the texts, and sustains the use of varied, relevant evidence.

- *“Peaches and Sharon have a wonderful time together...happy as anything.”*
- *“Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can’t even put it into words.”*
- *“You know, pig, you’re driving me crazy...It makes me disgruntled.”*
- *“‘Piggy, cheer up. Follow me’...He sleeps on the settee...cozy as we can be.”*

The response exhibits clear organization, with the use of appropriate transitions to create a unified whole.

- *however*
- *Because of this difference*
- *while it causes*
- *but also*
- *For instance, in Tym’s excerpt*
- *Another instance*
- *The narrator takes this experience*
- *to demonstrate*
- *Both excerpts*
- *in Bloom’s article*
- *but also*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.

- *taking in a pig in seeking for a friend*
- *their phenomenal and exceptional relationship*
- *it disturbs and causes great stress and severe issues that anger*
- *severe problematic relationship*
- *takes this experience to reflect to bond to make a phenomenal relationship*
- *the narrator reflects on this, which changes the plot to severely advance making character development*

The response provides a concluding statement that follows generally from the topic and information presented.

- *Both excerpts go over how the narrator bonds with the pig, however they do this both in explicitly different ways. In Tym’s article, the narrator successfully bonds with the big, making a phenomenal relationship, while in Bloom’s article, the narrator fails to do so*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *stories describes*
- *he had becam*
- *the big*

39 The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

The pigs in excerpts from "Pig Tales", and "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" both have pigs that have relationships with their owners. A similarity between the relationships or the pig's relationships is that they are spoiled. The pig from "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" sits on a settee and eats popcorn and tea and watches TV. I found this in line 51. His owners just like him do that therefore making him spoiled. The pig from "Pig Tales" also has a spoiled relationship because the pig's owners let the pig eat snacks and drink Pepsi. I found this in paragraph seven. The pig doesn't have to work for the food therefore making that pig spoiled just like the other pig from "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor". A difference between the relationships of each pig is that the pig from "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" is lonely while the pig from "Pig Tales" is very social. I know this because in "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor", line 46, the pig "says", "I'm so lonesome." On the other hand I know that the pig from "Pig Tales" is very social because in paragraph four the author talks about how the pig plays games with her owners therefore being social. The relationship of the pig from "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" helps move the plot forward because the pig is lonely and because of that he tries to escape and then he eventually joins his humans and moves into their household therefore moving the plot. The pig from "Pig Tales" moves the plot forward by being cute and bringing joy to the owners' heart. This is how these relationships help advance the plot in each of the stories and the similarities and differences between the pig's different relationships.

Score Credit 3 (out of 4 credits)

This response clearly introduces a topic in a manner that follows from the task and purpose.

- *The pigs in excerpts from "Pig Tales", and "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" both have pigs that have relationships with their owners*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate analysis of the texts.

- *A similarity between the relationships of the pig's relationships is that they are spoiled*
- *The pig doesn't have to work for the food therefore making that pig spoiled just like the other pig*
- *A difference between the relationships of each pig is that the pig from "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" is lonely while the pig from "Pig Tales" is very social*
- *The relationship of the pig from "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" helps move the plot forward because the pig is lonely and because of that he tries to escape and then he eventually joins his humans and moves into their household therefore moving the plot. The pig from "Pig Tales" moves the plot forward by being cute and bringing joy to the owners heart*

The response develops the topic with relevant details from the texts, and sustains the use of relevant evidence, with some lack of variety.

- *sits on a settee and eats popcorn and tea and watches TV*
- *the pig's owners let the pig eat snacks and drink Pepsi*
- *pig "says", "I'm so lonesome."*
- *the pig plays games with her owners therefore being social*

The response exhibits clear organization, with the use of appropriate transitions to create a unified whole.

- *and*
- *both*
- *A similarity between*
- *from "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor"*
- *while*
- *I know this because*
- *On the other hand*
- *in paragraph four the author talks about*
- *This is how*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.

- *social*

The response provides a concluding statement that follows from the topic and information presented.

- *This is how these relationships help advance the plot in each of the stories and the similarities and differences between the pig's different relationships*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *there owners*
- *similarate*
- *therfore*
- *becasue*
- *diffrence*
- *relationsships*
- *socail*
- *konw*
- *withe her*
- *loney*
- *trys*
- *eventally*
- *the owners heart*
- *storys*
- *simlarteis and diffrences beteewn*

GUIDE PAPER 6a

39 The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

"Excerpt from Pig Tales" and "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" have very similar relationships with there owners but also very different. One way, these pigs have similar relationships with there owners is

"We watch TV, Have popcorn and tea As cozy as we can be" and "curls up to watch TV with her and even sleeps in Sharon's bed!" This proves that they have similar relationships with there owners because it's showing how they love to bond through comfort.

One way, these pigs have different relationships with there owners is "I want to be free," and "One day when Sharon had to leave the house... Sharon returned home she found Peaches, in the middle of the floor . . . "sobbing!" This proves that they have different relationships with there owners because one pig wants to escape from there owner and the other can't bare when there owner leaves.

These relationships the pigs have with there owners help you connect with the characters more and truly understand how different people and animals can be.

In conclusion, both of these stories have very similar relationships with there owners but also very different. Without these little bumps in the road these stories truly wouldn't be the same.

Score Credit 3 (out of 4 credits)

This response clearly introduces a topic in a manner that follows from the task and purpose.

- *"Excerpt from Pig Tales" and "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" have very similar relationships with there owners but also very different*

GUIDE PAPER 6b

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate analysis of the texts.

- *One way, these pigs have similar relationships with there owners is [...] showing how they love to bond through comfort*
- *One way, these pigs have different relationships with there owners is [...] because one pig wants to escape from there owner and the other can't bare when there owner leaves*
- *These relationships the pigs have with there owners help you connect with the characters more and truly understand how different people and animals can be*

The response develops the topic with relevant details from the texts, and sustains the use of relevant evidence, with some lack of variety.

- *"We watch TV, Have popcorn and tea As cozy as we can be"*
- *"curls up to watch TV with her and even sleeps in Sharon's bed!"*
- *"I want to be free,"*
- *"One day when Sharon had to leave the house... Sharon returned home she found Peaches, in the middle of the floor . . . "sobbing!"*

The response exhibits clear organization, with the use of appropriate transitions to create a unified whole.

- *One way*
- *and*
- *This proves*
- *because*
- *In conclusion*
- *but*
- *without*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.

The response provides a concluding statement that is compelling and follows clearly from the topic and information presented.

- *In conclusion, both of these stories have very similar relationships with there owners but also very different. Without these little bumps in the road these stories truly wouldn't be the same*

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *there owners*
- *can't bare*

GUIDE PAPER 7a

39 The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

"Excerpt from *Pig Tales*" and "*We Keep a Pig in the Parlor*" both have relationships with their owners that are similar and different. They are similar because it states, "So, we keep our pig in the parlor;

He sleeps on the settee.

We watch TV,

Have popcorn and tea

As cozy as we can be," and "Peaches and Sharon have a wonderful time together. As long as Peaches is rested and well fed she's as happy as anything. She loves the pillows on Sharon's couch and if one of them happens to be on the floor she runs up and grabs it with her snout and tosses it up in the air." This shows us how the relationship between the two are similar, ghey both have a happy relationship with a pig. They are different because it also states,

"Some people keep pigs in a pigpen,

Or out in a field roaming free.

We keep a pig in the parlor.

He sleeps on the settee.¹

He used to live in the pig barn,

And sit looking out at the field,

Till a plan took shape

For a great escape,

"I want to be free," he squealed. He fairly flew out of the window,

With a run and a jump and a grunt.

He came down in the mud

With a squishy, soft thud,

GUIDE PAPER 7b

It was quite an incredible stunt," and " When she arrived at the house that had three pigs for sale, Sharon knew she wasn't going to leave without one . . . they were all so cute. And when she looked at Peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one.

Peaches was amazing: she picked up on things so quickly." This shows us how origin background of the pigs are different since one was in a barn and the other one was in another state.

These relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem because both of the lot ended in a house. For example, "on says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words. There is never a dull moment with Peaches around and their relationship is a perfect partnership as Peaches only gives back the love she gets given by having a very special place in a very special household," and " So, we keep our pig in the parlor;

He sleeps on the settee.

We watch TV,

Have popcorn and tea

As cozy as we can be. " This shows us how the story plot change during the reading.

Score Credit 2 (out of 4 credits)

This response clearly introduces a topic in a manner that follows from the task and purpose.

- *"Excerpt from Pig Tales" and "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor" both have relationships with their owners that are similar and different*

The response demonstrates a literal comprehension of the texts.

- *the relationship between the two are similar, ghey both have a happy relationship with a pig*
- *origin backround of the pigs are different since one was in a barn and the other one was in another state*
- *These relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem because both of the lot ended in a house*
- *how the story plot chaange during the reading*

The response develops the topic with relevant details from the texts, and sustains the use of relevant evidence, with some lack of variety.

- *"So, we keep our pig in the parlor; He sleeps on the settee. We watch TV, Have popcorn and tea As cozy as we can be,"*
- *"Peaches and Sharon have a wonderful time together. As long as Peaches is rested and well fed she's as happy as anything. She loves the pillows on Sharon's couch and if one of them happens to be on the floor she runs up and grabs it with her snout and tosses it up in the air."*

GUIDE PAPER 7c

- *“Some people keep pigs in a pigpen, Or out in a field roaming free. We Keep a Pig in the Parlor. He sleeps on the settee. He used to live in the pig barn, And sit looking out at the field, Till a plan took shape For a great escape, “I want to be free,” he squealed. He fairly flew out of the window, With a run and a jump and a grunt. He came down in the mud With a squishy, soft thud, It was quite an incredible stunt,*
- *“ When she arrived at the house that had three pigs for sale, Sharon knew she wasn’t going to leave without one . . . they were all so cute. And when she looked at Peaches, the only girl in the bunch, she knew she was the one. Peaches was amazing: she picked up on things so quickly.”*
- *“on says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can’t even put it into words. There is never a dull moment with Peaches around and their relationship is a perfect partnership as Peaches only gives back the love she gets given by having a very special place in a very special household,”*
- *“ So, we keep our pig in the parlor He sleeps on the settee. We watch TV, Have popcorn and tea As cozy as we can be. ”*

The response exhibits some attempt at organization, with inconsistent use of transitions.

- *both*
- *because it states*
- *and*
- *This shows us how*
- *also*
- *For example*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.

The response does not provide a concluding statement.

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *ghey*
- *backround*
- *chaange*

- 39 The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

In both the story and the poem, they have multiple similarities and differences. In the poem it states "You know, pig, you're driving me crazy. Why are you doing this stuff? The garden and barn are a terrible mess. Enough is enough is enough!" This shows that the pig and its owner are in an argument and the owner is mad at the pig because the pig is "driving him crazy". In the text of the story it states "Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words." The difference between the two is that the poem is about how the pig is driving the owner crazy and then the story is about how the pig is an amazing thing that came into Sharon's life. In the poem it also states "Piggy, cheer up. Follow me. So, we keep our pig in the parlor; He sleeps on the settee. We watch TV, Have popcorn and tea As cozy as we can be. In the story it repeatedly states that "Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words." This similarity is based on how the owner of the pig in the poem is becoming very close with the pig and starts bonding and in the story Sharon has a lot of love for Peaches which makes them similar. In both the poem and the story, they both help the poem and the story's plot advance because in the poem it starts off with the pig being alone and being treated differently and the pig had to sleep outside in the barn meanwhile in the story the pig Peaches got to sleep with its owner all cozied up in their bed. The pig in the poem had squealed saying "I want to be free." The pig had been very lonely outside in the barn all alone. The story and the poem both ended up in a happy friendship with the owners and their pigs.

Score Credit 2 (out of 4 credits)

This response introduces a topic in a manner that follows generally from the task and purpose.

- *In both the story and the poem, they have multiple similarities and differences*

The response demonstrates a literal comprehension of the texts.

- *the pig and its owner are in an argument and the owner is mad at the pig because the pig is "driving him crazy"*

- *The difference between the two is that the poem is about how the pig is driving the owner crazy and then the story is about how the pig is an amazing thing that came into Sharon's life*
- *This similarity is based on how the owner of the pig in the poem is becoming very close with the pig and starts bonding and in the story Sharon has a lot of love for Peaches which makes them similar. In both the poem and the story, they both help the poem and the story's plot advance because in the poem it starts off with the pig being alone and being treated differently and the pig had to sleep outside in the barn meanwhile in the story the pig Peaches got to sleep with its owner all cozied up in their bed*
- *The pig had been very lonely outside in the barn all alone*

The response partially develops the topic of the essay with the use of some textual evidence, some of which may be irrelevant.

- *"You know, pig, you're driving me crazy. Why are you doing this stuff? The garden and barn are a terrible mess. Enough is enough is enough!"*
- *"Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words."*
- *"Piggy, cheer up. Follow me. So, we keep our pig in the parlor; He sleeps on the settee. We watch TV, Have popcorn and tea As cozy as we can be"*
- *"Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words."*
- *The pig in the poem had squealed saying "I want to be free,"*

The response exhibits some attempt at organization, with inconsistent use of transitions.

- *In both the story and the poem*
- *In the poem it states*
- *This shows that*
- *In the text of the story it states*
- *The difference between*
- *also*
- *In the story it repeatedly states*
- *both*

The response establishes and maintains a formal style using precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.

The response provides a concluding statement that follows generally from the topic and information presented.

- *The story and the poem both ended up in a happy friendship with the owners and their pigs*

The response demonstrates emerging command of conventions, with some errors that may hinder comprehension.

- *thpig*
- *a argument*
- *drivig*
- *sharons life*
- *sette*
- *i the poem*
- *storys*
- Capitalization
- Punctuation

GUIDE PAPER 9a

39 The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

In the story, Peaches and Sharon's relationship is very close and fun, while in the poem, the relationship between the owner and the pig is not as close and nice as the story. The relationships in both the story and the poem help advance the plots because new things keep happening with Peaches and Sharon in the story, and in the poem it is telling us how they came to be owner and pet. In the story, paragraph four has a bunch of different things that have happened to the two of them together. For example, it says, "She loves the pillows on Sharon's couch and if one of them happens to be on the floor she runs up and grabs it with her snout and tosses it up in the air," showing one of the fun things they do together. In the poem it just keeps telling us how they met and the progress in their pet/owner relationship.

Score Credit 2 (out of 4 credits)

This response introduces a topic in a manner that follows generally from the task and purpose.

- *In the story, Peaches and Sharon's relationship is very close and fun, while in the poem, the relationship between the owner and the pig is not as close and nice as the story*

The response demonstrates a literal comprehension of the texts.

- *Peaches and Sharon's relationship is very close and fun [...] the relationship between the owner and the pig is not as close and nice as the story*
- *The relationships in both the story and the poem help advance the plots because new things keep happening with Peaches and Sharon in the story, and in the poem it is telling us how they came to be owner and pet*
- *showing one of the fun things they do together*
- *it just keeps telling us how they met and the progress in their pet/owner relationship*

GUIDE PAPER 9b

The response partially develops the topic of the essay with the use of some textual evidence, uses relevant evidence with inconsistency.

- *“She loves the pillows on Sharon’s couch and if one of them happens to be on the floor she runs up and grabs it with her snout and tosses it up in the air,”*

The response exhibits some attempt at organization, with inconsistent use of transitions.

- *In the story*
- *while in the poem*
- *both*
- *because*
- *For example, it says*
- *showing*

The response lacks a formal style, using language that is imprecise for the texts and task.

- *nice*
- *new things keep happening*
- *a bunch of different things*
- *it just keeps telling us*

The response does not provide a concluding statement.

The response demonstrates grade-appropriate command of conventions, with occasional errors that do not hinder comprehension.

- *te plots*
- *how the came*

GUIDE PAPER 10a

- 39 The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

In both stories the pigs in the stories are very similar.

The pig in "Pig Tales" was smart. The pig in "We Keep a Pig in the Parlor", was also smart enough to escape his old pen. Both pigs in the stories live with their owners in the house. Both pigs were loney they both needed their owners with them. This helps show how good of an relationship the pigs have with their owners. Both owners never have a dull moment with their pigs. Both pigs are treated like children. Both pigs are loved by their owners. Both pigs have a special place in the household.

Score Credit 1 (out of 4 credits)

This response introduces a topic in a manner that does not logically follow from the task and purpose.

- *In both stories the pigs in the stories are very similar*

The response demonstrates little understanding of the texts.

- *Both pigs in the stories live with their owners in the house. Both pigs were loney they both needed their owners with them. This helps show how good of an relationship the pigs have with their owners. Both owners never have a dull moment with their pigs. Both pigs are treated like children. Both pigs are loved by their owners. Both pigs have a special place in the household*

The response demonstrates an attempt to use evidence, but only develops ideas with minimal, occasional evidence, which is generally irrelevant.

- *was also smart enough to escape his old pen*

The response exhibits little attempt at organization.

The response lacks a formal style, using language that is imprecise for the texts and task.

The response does not provide a concluding statement.

GUIDE PAPER 10b

The response demonstrates emerging command of conventions, with some errors that may hinder comprehension.

- *loney*
- *an relationship*

- 39 The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

The similarity's are that both books had pigs and a owner that loved the pigs. It said in the text, "As I hugged him I had an idea.

"Piggy, cheer up". And "Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words". So this shows both owners liked their pets. The diffrences in the book are the point of view the books are in the book *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* is in the pigs point of veiw while in *Pig Tales* a narratior is telling the story.

Score Credit 1 (out of 4 credits)

This response introduces a topic in a manner that follows generally from the task and purpose.

- *The similarity's are [...] The diffrences*

The response demonstrates little understanding of the texts.

- *The similarity's are that both books had pigs and a owner that loved the pigs*
- *this shows both owners liked their pets*
- *The diffrences in the book are the point of view the books are in the book *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* is in the pigs point of veiw while in *Pig Tales* a narratior is telling the story*

The response demonstrates an attempt to use evidence, but only develops ideas with minimal, occasional evidence, which is generally irrelevant.

- *"As I hugged him I had an idea. "Piggy, cheer up"*
- *"Sharon says that Peaches has brought so much joy to her life that she can't even put it into words"*

The response exhibits little attempt at organization.

- *both*
- *It said in the text*

- *And*
- *So this shows*

The response establishes but fails to maintain a formal style, with inconsistent use of language and domain-specific vocabulary.

The response does not provide a concluding statement.

The response demonstrates emerging command of conventions, with some errors that may hinder comprehension.

- *similarity's*
- *a owner*
- *diffrences*
- *veiw*
- *narrator*

GUIDE PAPER 12a

- 39 The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

In The Poem The Owner At First Did Not Accept The Pig In His Parlor And In The Story Sharon Accepted The Pig Right Away In The Poem The Owner Looks Like He Did Not Bring The Pig Home And Did Not Gave The Pig Attention And In The Story Sharong Gave The Pig Baths Let Her Sleep In Her Bed And Played With Her.

Score Credit 1 (out of 4 credits)

This response introduces a topic in a manner that does not logically follow from the task and purpose.

- *In The Poem The Owner [...] And In The Story Sharon*

The response demonstrates little understanding of the texts.

- *In The Poem The Owner At First Did Not Accept The Pig In His Parlor And In The Story Sharon Accepted The Pig Right Away*
- *In The Poem The Owner Looks Like He Did Not Bring The Pig Home And Did Not Gave The Pig Attention*

The response demonstrates an attempt to use evidence, but only develops ideas with minimal, occasional evidence, which is generally irrelevant.

- *Sharong Gave The Pig Baths Let Her Sleep In Her Bed And Played With Her*

The response lacks a formal style, using language that is imprecise for the texts and task.

The response exhibits no evidence of organization.

The response does not provide a concluding statement.

The response demonstrates a lack of command of conventions, with frequent errors that hinder comprehension.

- *Sharong*
- Capitalization

GUIDE PAPER 13

39 The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

In " Excerpt from pig Tales " they keep there pig and there very own house. But in " We keep a pig in a parlor " they keep there pig in a parlor! Also in " Expert from pig tales " the pig loves to play woth toys and anything like that. But in " We keep a pig in the parlor " that pig really likes tv, tea, and realaxing.

Score Credit 0 (out of 4 credits)

This response demonstrates a lack of comprehension of the texts or task.

- In " Excerpt from pig Tales " they keep there pig and there very own house. But in " We keep a pig in a parlor " they keep there pig in a parlor! Also in " Expert from pig tales " the pig loves to play woth toys and anything like that. But in " We keep a pig in the parlor " that pig really likes tv, tea, and realaxing

39 The pigs in *Pig Tales* and *We Keep a Pig in the Parlor* both have relationships with their owners. What is similar and different about these relationships? How do these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem? Use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response.

In your response, be sure to

- describe what is similar and different about the relationships between the pigs and their owners in both the story and the poem
- explain how these relationships help to advance the plot in both the story and the poem
- use details from **both** the story and the poem to support your response

In "We keep a Pig in the Parlor" the pig is not happy. In "Pig tales" the pig is happy. "Pig tales" is a article about why pigs are good pets so they show the pig happy. In "We keep a Pig in the Parlor" the poem is showing what it is like to be a pig in captivity.

Score Credit 0 (out of 4 credits)

This response demonstrates a lack of comprehension of the texts or task.

- In "We keep a Pig in the Parlor" the pig is not happy. In "Pig tales" the pig is happy. "Pig tales" is a article about why pigs are good pets so they show the pig happy. In "We keep a Pig in the Parlor" the poem is showing what it is like to be a pig in captivity